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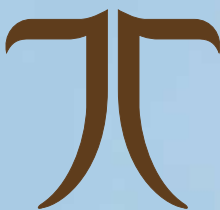
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‘Experience it bloom in
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ETHANOL BLENDING
HC orders removal of videos targeting Gadkari
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DEPLETED DEFENCE
Russia's missile barrage on Kyiv kills 17
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HORMUZ NAVIGATION
New route agreed with Oman, says Iran
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Misleading contentions and unkept promises
Did reorganising J&K to a U.T. make a difference?
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JHARKHAND SIR
Over 43 lakh voters deleted from draft rolls
NEWS » PAGE 11



Tasmac shops must issue bill for each sale: HC

CHENNAI
The Madras High Court has directed the Tamil Nadu State Marketing Corporation (Tasmac) to ensure that bill books are maintained in every retail liquor shop run by it and that consumers are issued bills for every purchase. » PAGE 7

‘Efforts on to get nod for Metro Rail extension’

CHENNAI
Finance Minister N. Marie Wilson has said that Tamil Nadu is taking efforts to secure the Centre's approval for the three Chennai Metro Rail extension projects. » PAGE 3

METROPLUS » 6 PAGES

Rijiju meets Rahul in bid to end Parliament logjam

Parliamentary Affairs Minister says there is no proposal to hold Special Session to push through women's quota and delimitation Bills; Cong. presses for Shah's statement, debate on donation row

Sandeep Phukan
NEW DELHI

Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju met Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi on Wednesday in an effort to break the deadlock in Parliament, with the two sides discussing the proposed delimitation Bill and the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment (FCRA) Bill, 2026.

Amid speculation that the government could convene a three-day session after Independence Day to push through the women's reservation Bill and the delimitation Bill, Mr. Rijiju told *The Hindu* that “there is no such proposal”.

Sources said Mr. Rijiju did not raise any proposal to extend the ongoing



Congress MPs Rahul Gandhi, Mallikarjun Kharge, and others protest against the Centre at Parliament complex on Wednesday. PTI

Monsoon Session or convene a Special Session during the nearly 50-minute meeting with Mr. Gandhi. Instead, he sought to know the Congress's stand on delimitation, they said.

‘Non-negotiable’
According to sources, Mr. Gandhi conveyed to Mr. Ri-

jiju that a statement by Home Minister Amit Shah on the police action against students who protested against the NEET paper leak and a discussion on the alleged theft of donations at the Ram Temple in Ayodhya were non-negotiable if the House was to function.

The meeting, held in Mr. Gandhi's Parliament office, was attended by Congress general secretary (organisation) K.C. Venugopal, deputy leader in the Lok Sabha Gaurav Gogoi, and Wayanad MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra.

The Congress leaders also reiterated their opposition to any constitutional amendment to carry out the delimitation exercise, sources added.

The government's outreach came on a day when Opposition MPs held a symbolic march within the Parliament complex, questioning Mr. Shah's continued absence from the House.

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RELATED REPORTS ON
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Vijay govt.'s debut Budget strikes a balance between welfare and fiscal prudence

B. Kolappan
N. Sai Charan
CHENNAI

The Tamilaga Vetti Kazhagam (TVK)-led government, of Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, on Wednesday presented its first Budget, seeking to strike a balance between fiscal prudence and welfare and focussing on empowerment of women, youth, students, and the elderly.

While some of the TVK's election promises figured in the Budget, several others did not. The Budget, presented by Finance Minister N. Marie Wilson, also prioritised skill development, rural and infrastructure development.

Mr. Wilson said the State's outstanding debt is put at ₹10.98 lakh crore in the Revised Budget Esti-

Key highlights

The first Budget presented by the TVK-led government focuses on empowerment of women, youth, and the elderly



- **Annan Seer:** 8-gram gold coin and silk saree for brides
- **‘Arivagam’:** India's first AI and innovation city with an AI university
- **TN-SUDAR:** 200 integrated student hostels with 1 lakh modern beds



■ **After-school sports:** One-hour daily programme in government and aided schools

■ **Kamarajar Schools of Excellence:** Free residential schools for Classes IX-XII with boarding, food, textbooks and uniforms



mates for 2026-27. The outstanding debt-to-GSDP ratio is estimated at 27.01%.

The government plans to borrow ₹1,73,445 crore and repay ₹51,971 crore this fiscal. The State's Own Tax Revenue is projected to

grow by 9.78%, with commercial taxes accounting for 68.9% of the collections, followed by Stamps and Registration (15.5%) and State Excise (6.2%).

MORE REPORTS ON
» PAGES 4 & 6

RBI panel keeps repo rate steady at 5.25%

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

The Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) voted unanimously on Wednesday to keep the policy repo rate under the liquidity adjustment facility (LAF) unchanged at 5.25%, after a detailed assessment of the evolving macroeconomic and financial developments.

Consequently, the standing deposit facility (SDF) rate remains at 5%, and the marginal standing facility (MSF) rate and the bank rate remain at 5.5%.

The MPC also decided to continue with the neutral stance.

RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra, in his monetary

policy statement, said the Indian economy has remained resilient amid persisting global headwinds.

Robust consumption
“High-frequency indicators available so far point towards steady domestic demand in Q1: 2026-27. Private consumption remained robust. Investment continues to be resilient, as suggested by various indicators,” he said.

“External demand also sustained, as healthy expansion in services exports was complemented by a rebound in merchandise exports,” he stated.

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‘ENOUGH FUNDS FOR UPI’
» PAGE 13

Monsoon rhythm



Children play on a waterlogged street in New Delhi after heavy rain left several roads submerged on Wednesday, disrupting movement in different parts of the city. The India Meteorological Department has forecast moderate rain on Thursday. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

CJP will function as a pressure group: Dipke

Vinaya Deshpande Pandit
MUMBAI

The Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) on Wednesday ruled out a political debut for now and announced it will go to Jharkhand to extend support for the students protesting against alleged irregularities in State recruitment examinations.

Claiming that people have lost faith in institutions, the founder of the group, Abhijeet Dipke, said that the CJP will work as a “pressure group”. “May it be politics, judiciary, the media, or the Election Commission, their credibility has reduced. They need to be made accountable, neutral,” he said in Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar in Maharashtra, where



Abhijeet Dipke

the CJP's core committee has gathered for a two-day meeting to outline a road map. The CJP will keep working on issues related to education, employment, inflation, high cost of living, and the economy, Mr. Dipke said.

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JHARKHAND PROTEST
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Meta apologises for ‘errors in operating platform’ as govt. summons senior official

Nistula Hebbar
Aroon Deep
NEW DELHI

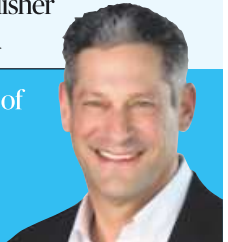
Meta chief executive officer Mark Zuckerberg conveyed his “apologies” for child sex abuse material (CSAM), deepfake content, and “errors in operating the platform”, government sources said, after Joel Kaplan, the technology giant's global head of public policy, met with officials from the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology on Wednesday.

“Meta will be called again,” the sources said, indicating that further meetings are on the slate. The delegation led by Mr. Kaplan also met Union Infor-



If he [Mr. Zuckerberg] fails to tender an unqualified apology within 3 days of receipt of this letter, the protection/immunity given under Section 79(3) of IT Act may be withdrawn and action taken against him as a publisher

STANDING COMMITTEE LETTER



I apologised... on behalf of Meta for the error restricting PM Modi's post

JOEL KAPLAN
Meta's Chief Global Affairs Officer

mation Technology Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw.

Mr. Kaplan had been summoned, among other things, to explain why Prime Minister Narendra Modi's first video message to the youth posted on July 23 was temporarily re-

moved from Facebook. The company had attributed it to an error. The government had insisted on full accounting of the error and a personal apology from Mr. Zuckerberg. The informal readout of the meeting did not include a

specific reference to that post's takedown.

“I apologised to the Minister on behalf of Meta for the error restricting PM Modi's post,” Mr. Kaplan later said in a statement.

The meetings follow heightened discussions around Instagram's role in amplifying the protests at Jantar Mantar last month, as well as the brief takedown of Mr. Modi's post on Facebook. Officials asserted that Meta was “not covered under intermediary definition” – a significant statement – since this would make the company liable in court for every single post by users.

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Hasina says fear will not decide her duty to people

Kallol Bhattacharjee
NEW DELHI

Former Bangladesh Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina, who was deposed in 2024 following protests, on Wednesday virtually addressed a press conference here, and said “fear” and “concerns of personal safety” will not prevent her from returning home.

She also called for lifting the ban on her Awami League party and termed India a country that has “always been a friend” and supported Bangladesh when it faced difficulties.

FULL REPORT ON
» PAGE 10

Having majority no reason for lawmakers to defy party: SC

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court made it clear on Wednesday that a group of MLAs or MPs cannot override the official directives of the parent political party merely for the reason that they hold a majority among the elected members.

Justice Joymalya Bagchi, part of a three-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, said the maturity of a democracy was measured by the constancy of political parties and their members to their ideology. The court was hearing a dispute between the Shiv Sena factions led by Uddhav Thackeray and current Maharashtra De-



Justice Joymalya Bagchi

puty Chief Minister Eknath Shinde over which was the real party and the rightful bearer of the party symbol.

Senior advocate Kapil Sibal, appearing for Mr. Thackeray, said “mergers” orchestrated by a faction of MLAs or MPs were not dictated by democratic or ideological powers, but a naked pursuit of power.

“You are carrying this she-nanigan to an absurd level where the entire electoral process becomes a farce because the electoral verdict can be changed through manipulation and defection. The government that comes into existence is not the government that the people voted for. This has huge repercussions,” Mr. Sibal said.

The court, meanwhile, indicated the striking of a balance between the electorate's decision to vote a party to power and the individual representatives' liberty to express genuine disagreement with the party's decisions.

CONTINUED ON
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M CH-CHE

Thirteen automated external defibrillators (AEDs) were inaugurated at the city airport on Wednesday as part of the 'HeartSafe' initiative of Kauvery Hospital and Chennai airport. Manivannan S., founder and managing director, Kauvery Group of Hospitals, said the hospital's 24x7 emergency clinics were equipped with advanced medical equipment and supported by experienced emergency physicians, skilled nurses, and trained paramedics, who can respond immediately. "The addition of AEDs further strengthens our emergency response capability, enabling timely defibrillation alongside expert medical care," he added. Raja Kishore, director, Chennai airport, said, "The installation of the automated external defibrillators is an important step towards strengthening our emergency medical preparedness." As per a release, Kauvery Hospital has been operating a 24x7 emergency medical service at Chennai airport, with 49 healthcare professionals and four clinics.

N. Marie Wilson says the projects are under active consideration of the Centre; State govt. is also pursuing a plan to create Metro Rail connectivity from Hosur to Bommasandra in Karnataka

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Finance Minister N. Marie Wilson on Wednesday said the State government is taking efforts to secure the Centre's approval for the three Chennai Metro Rail extension projects.

In the Budget, he said, three stretches – Airport to Kilambakkam (₹9,335 crore), Koyambedu to Pattabiram via Avadi (₹9,744 crore), and Poonamallee to Sunguvarchathiram via Sriperumbudur (₹8,779 crore) – have been recommended by the State government, and is under the active consideration of the Government of India.



Long wait: The Minister said the phase II stretch from Poonamallee Bypass to Vadapalani was 'scheduled to be commissioned for public use shortly.' B. VELANKANNI RAJ

The detailed project reports (DPR) for these projects were forwarded last year to the Union Government, and was recently re-

viewed by the Network Planning Group.

Sources said these projects need to receive the nod from NITI Aayog, Pu-

blic Investment Board, and finally from the Union Cabinet.

Mr. Wilson also said, the ongoing 118.9 km phase II Metro Rail network, coming up at an estimated completion cost of ₹63,246 crore, was progressing in full swing, and the first stretch from Poonamallee Bypass to Porur Junction, connecting Vadapalani station (14.64 km), was “scheduled to be commissioned for public use shortly.”

The State government has been pursuing the proposal to create Metro Rail connectivity from Hosur in Krishnagiri district to Bommasandra in Karnataka with the Centre and the Karnataka government.

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The allocation for Higher Education Department in Revised Budget 2026-27 has dropped by ₹101 crore compared to last fiscal, prompting sharp response from educationists and activists. The total outlay for the department has been put at ₹8,393 crore.

In his Budget speech, Finance Minister N. Marie Wilson highlighted the allocation of ₹2,000 crore for 'Vetri Laptop Scheme' for college students and the proposal to establish a specialised government law college in Madurai with an intake of 300 students. He also announced the setting up of Tamil Nadu Student Housing and Infrastructure Corporation to build 200 integrated students' hostels with one lakh beds through a Public-Private Partnership (PPP) model at a total capital outlay of ₹3,200 crore, with a State grant of ₹640 crore.

The budget documents indicate that the government has allocated ₹1,807 as grant to universities, which is an increase from ₹1,678 crore last fiscal. Besides, there has been a marginal rise in the amount allocated for payment of fees of students admitted to colleges under the 7.5% horizontal reservation scheme.

Reacting to the budget, G. Thiruvivasagam, former vice-chancellor of University of Madras said that 20-odd universities in the State have over 50% vacancy in faculty positions. If the government seeks to fill up the vacancies, the allocation will not be enough. Although the universities and colleges in the State have fared better than others in the country in NIRF rankings, poor funding from the government has begun to take a toll. "All universities are low on resources. The allocation would not even meet a fraction of their requirement," Dr. Thiruvivasagam asserted. He said that public universities were losing students to private universities because of better infrastructure, laboratory facilities, and technology-oriented teaching materials there. "If we are to attract more students to our universities, we need to increase funding several times," he added.

Meanwhile, P.B. Prince Gajendra Babu, general secretary, State Platform for Common School System-Tamil Nadu, raised concerns over cost of accommodation and food at the students' hostels built under the PPP model.

He said there was significant risk that it would impose heavy financial burden on both students and parents, especially first generation learners and women students.

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

To reshape the urban landscape in Tamil Nadu by 2031, the State government's 2026-27 Budget has launched the ₹2,117-crore 'Chief Minister's Integrated Urban Development Mission', a multi-sectoral project focusing on civic infrastructure, urban public health, and AI-driven e-go-

vernance. In the revised Budget estimates, a total of ₹29,863 crore was allocated to the Municipal Administration and Water Supply Department. This is an increase from the ₹28,227 crore allocated by the DMK-led government during the Interim Budget 2026-27.

According to the Budget, the Mission will bring under one roof urban in-

frastructure, water supply, underground sewerage system, integrated solid waste management, city roads, urban transport, expansion of green spaces, protection of urban waterbodies, social infrastructure, safety of women and children, AI-driven e-governance, and a dedicated 'Urban Public Health Improvement Mission.'

The Budget said the In-

telligent Transport Management System, within Greater Chennai Corporation, is in its final stage of implementation. "A comprehensive street redesign and urban mobility project will also be implemented, with key emphasis on pedestrian infrastructure, accessibility, and urban design enhancements, including smart parking management at 20 loca-

tions and restructuring of roads in the Ambattur and Guindy Industrial Estates," it added. To expand the city's green canopy and create people-centric public spaces, footpaths along major routes and residential zones will also undergo greening and beautification, the Budget added.

“People-friendly streets will be developed in all Municipal Corporations,

transforming them into modern urban thoroughfares with proper road connectivity, dedicated pedestrian pathways, separate cycling lanes, well-connected cross-streets, junction improvements, safe school access networks, and modern LED street lighting.”



Vellore International School
Chennai

PRESENTS

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Govt. needs two years to restore fiscal prudence: Finance Minister

‘Unlike previous govt. that focused on short-term political gains, we believe we need to achieve sustained growth’

Tamil Nadu’s fiscal position remains under strain, and the new government inherited a treasury burdened with debt, inadequate income, and systemic leakages, Finance Minister N. Marie Wilson said on Wednesday.

Presenting the Revised Budget 2026-27 in the Assembly, he said the process of repair had begun, but it would require at least two years to bring the financial administration back on the track of fiscal prudence.

He said that under the leadership of Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, the government aimed to build fiscally prudent governance capable of delivering balanced and inclusive economic growth. “Unlike the previous government, which focused only on short-term political gains with the belief that they should make the best use of their five-year term, our government believes that we need to look forward to at least 15 years of sustained growth through consistent policies and clean and efficient governance,” the Minister said.

“The State has been borrowing without reference to what its revenues can sustain. While there is nothing wrong with borrowing to invest in human and physical capital that acts as the driver of economic and social growth, this needs to be accompanied by corresponding efforts to mobilise resources that could cover such borrowings. The previous government failed to recognise this simple fact,” the Minister said.

“The previous government allowed revenue-earning departments to bleed uncontrollably, while permitting a substantial share of public money to be siphoned off by unscrupulous middlemen,” he said.

Since the formation of the current government, he said, continuous efforts had been made to plug the leakage in revenue and expenditure, enabling the government to generate at least ₹1,500 crore from the revenue side so far. It also expected to create substantial fiscal space on the expenditure side through savings in the procurement of goods and services, he added.

Welfare schemes

The Minister reiterated that welfare schemes – such as scholarship, free education for students, subsidies for entrepreneurs to start businesses and manufacturing units and for PDS, and free housing for the poor – were not largesse but investment in human and social capital that drove consumption and long-term economic growth. The government would continue most of the welfare schemes that had been implemented for the past three decades, and planned to expand them. However, it believed that a calibrated balance was necessary between investment in welfare schemes and investment in physical capital and infrastructure. Such measures required adequate resources and fiscal space, and without sustained efforts in this regard, welfare schemes could not be continued, he said.

Only ‘zero marks’ to Budget, govt. merely renamed schemes: EPS

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami on Wednesday criticised the first Budget presented by the TVK-led coalition government, saying he would give it only “zero marks.”

Speaking to reporters at the Secretariat after the presentation of the Budget, Mr. Palaniswami said the ruling party had made several promises before coming to power, but

none of them had found a place in the Budget. He alleged that the government had merely renamed existing schemes.

“Only a sticker has been pasted on the existing schemes. None of the poll promises has been fulfilled,” he said.

Recalls promises

He recalled that the TVK had promised to increase the monthly entitlement for women to ₹2,500, and the old-age pension to ₹3,000. However, no an-

nouncement was made in this regard in the Budget, he said. “What happened to the promise of increas-

ing the medical insurance cover to ₹25 lakh for all families,” he asked.

Mr. Palaniswami said



Bleak assessment: AIADMK leader Edappadi K. Palaniswami emerging from the Assembly on Wednesday. S.R. RAGHUNATHAN

nouncement was made in this regard in the Budget, he said. “What happened to the promise of increas-

ing the medical insurance cover to ₹25 lakh for all families,” he asked.

Mr. Palaniswami said

TVK government’s first Budget strikes the right chord with captains of industry

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The first Budget of the TVK government received a positive response from industries and chambers of commerce in Tamil Nadu, with industry leaders calling it a progressive Budget that focuses on growth and development.

“This Budget delivers on fundamentals of industrial competitiveness, AI-led investment facilitation, and infrastructure

built for scale. Battery storage, rooftop solar, smart metering, and EV charging networks aren’t add-ons here; they are core to Tamil Nadu’s pitch as India’s top investment destination. These steps will also help MSMEs unlock the full potential of India’s Free Trade Agreements and propel manufacturing growth across the State,” said Ravichandran Purushothaman, chairman, CII Southern Region, and president,

Danfoss India.

“New ITIs, AI and robotics training, and expanded apprenticeships mean the talent pipeline is being built in parallel, not as an afterthought,” said Murugavel Janakiraman, vice-chairman, CII Tamil Nadu, and founder and CEO of Matrimony.com.

The Madras Chamber of Commerce & Industry (MCCI) said the Budget reflects a conscious effort to balance long-term economic priorities with in-

Industry leaders call it a progressive Budget that focuses on growth and development

vestments in human capital and social development. A. Viswanathan, president, MCCI, said: “The Budget sets a positive direction by according priority to manufacturing, infrastructure, technology, MSMEs, skill

development and ease of doing business. These are all critical to Tamil Nadu’s long-term growth and global competitiveness.” He said the Chamber looks forward to working closely with the government in the formulation and implementation of the proposed Industrial Policy and other key reforms to help shape a competitive, future-ready industrial ecosystem for Tamil Nadu.

Mehul H. Doshi, president, CREDAI Chennai,

said the MY-HOME Affordable Housing Scheme, aimed at providing affordable homes for working-class youth and lower-income families through the Public-Private Partnership (PPP) model, is a welcome initiative.

“Fiscal discipline and development don’t usually move together; this Budget makes them [do so],” said C. Devarajan, chairman, CII Tamil Nadu State Council, and Managing Director, URC Con-

struction (P) Ltd.

V.N. Shiva Shanker, senior vice-president of SICCI, said the Chamber welcomes the proposed internship opportunities for 20,000 youth in the first phase, skill and employability training for one lakh job-seekers, and five new Industrial Training Institutes at an outlay of ₹90 crore. “Industry linkage will be critical to ensure that course design, assessment, and placements are aligned with de-

mand. SICCI stands ready to help shape curricula and facilitate internships and placements across its member network,” he added.

G.S.K. Velu, chairman, FICCI Tamil Nadu State Council, welcomed the substantial investments in healthcare, including maternal and child health programmes, telemedicine expansion, mobile geriatric care services, and strengthening public health infrastructure.

State’s outstanding debt is ₹10.98 lakh cr.

State’s Own Tax Revenue is pegged at ₹2,26,740 crore in the Revised Budget Estimates, when compared with the Interim Budget Estimates’ projection of ₹2,29,579 crore. The State will receive ₹8,160 crore in additional funds from the Centre as it will implement VB-G RAM G

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Tamil Nadu’s overall outstanding debt is estimated at ₹10,98,768 crore in the Revised Budget Estimates for 2026-27, as against ₹10,99,458 crore in the Interim Budget Estimates for 2026-27, Finance Minister N. Marie Wilson said.

Presenting the Revised Budget for 2026-27 in the Assembly, he said the outstanding debt includes public debt and public account liability. “Public debt includes ₹9,523 crore, which should be reflected in the accounts of the Union government after the approval of the Chennai Metro Rail Phase II project as a Central Sector Project,” he said.

The outstanding debt-to-GSDP ratio in the Revised Budget Estimates is estimated at 27.01%, as against 27.03% in the Interim Budget Estimates. In the Revised Budget Esti-

mates, State’s Own Tax Revenue (SOTR) is estimated at ₹2,26,740 crore, when compared with the Interim Budget Estimates’ projection of ₹2,29,579 crore.

“Aligning with the observations in the White Paper on Fiscal Management regarding past over-estimations, projections have been recalibrated downward in the Revised Budget Estimates,” Mr. Wilson said, adding that SOTR is projected to expand at a rate of 9.78% in 2026-27 over the Revised Estimates of 2025-26.

The State’s Own Non-Tax Revenue is estimated at ₹27,704 crore in the Interim Budget Estimates, as against ₹26,265 crore in the Revised Estimates of 2025-26. In the Revised Estimates for 2026-27, it is pegged at ₹27,835 crore.

Tamil Nadu will receive ₹8,160 crore in additional funds from the Centre in the current financial year, according to the Revised Budget Estimates. The in-



Status report: Finance Minister N. Marie Wilson presenting the Budget in the Assembly on Wednesday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

crease is largely on account of the State’s decision to implement the Viksit Bharat-Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) (VB-G RAM G), which replaced the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Scheme (MGNREGS). Under a 60:40 cost-sharing pattern, the Centre’s share for the scheme is ₹7,586 crore, while the State’s contribution is ₹5,057 crore. Ac-

cording to the Budget, grants-in-aid from the Centre were estimated at ₹24,762 crore in the Interim Budget Estimates for 2026-27. In the Revised Budget Estimates, it has gone up to ₹32,922 crore.

The share in central taxes was estimated at ₹56,819 crore in the Revised Estimates of 2025-26. The same was estimated at ₹62,531 crore in the Interim Budget Estimates for 2026-27, based on the Union government’s alloca-



Budget break-up

An overview of the TVK-led government’s first Budget, presented in the Assembly on Wednesday

Classification	2024-2025 Accounts	2025-2026 Revised Estimates	2026-2027 Interim Budget Estimates	2026-2027 Revised Budget Estimates
Total revenue receipts	2,82,829	3,09,698	3,44,575	3,50,027
Total revenue expenditure	3,28,669	3,78,917	3,93,272	4,05,802
Revenue deficit	45,840	69,219	48,696	55,775
Capital expenditure	47,108	51,443	59,562	56,985
Net loans & advances	8,439*	3,360	13,708	9,075
Fiscal deficit (as a % of GSDP)	3.25*	3.48	3	3
Outstanding debt (as a % of GSDP)	27.4	27.41	27.03	27.01
GSDP	31,15,998	35,67,818	40,67,312	40,67,312

*Includes transfer of ₹350 crore to Contingency Fund
All values except those for fiscal deficit and outstanding debt are ₹ in crore



Tamil Nadu’s fiscal position remains under strain, and the new government inherited a treasury burdened with debt, inadequate income, and systemic leakages

N. MARIE WILSON
Finance Minister

Finance Minister N. Marie Wilson with Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay ahead of the presentation of the Budget.

MAJOR SECTORAL ALLOCATIONS

Education
₹52,920 crore

Rural development
₹39,609 crore

Urban development
₹38,715 crore

Health
₹23,357 crore

Food and cooperation
₹22,859 crore

Highways
₹21,524 crore

Energy
₹15,828 crore

Police
₹14,552 crore

Transport
₹13,561 crore

Social welfare
₹9,819 crore

Water resources
₹9,264 crore

Industries and MSME
₹6,556 crore

Social justice
₹3,938 crore

Revised Budget a damp squib: Stalin

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

DMK president M.K. Stalin on Wednesday described the Revised Budget Estimates as a “damp squib”, saying they lacked originality and failed to fulfil the government’s promises.

“People expected it to be a ‘blast’, but it turned out to be a ‘waste’. It is a remake of the ‘Dravidian Model’ (DMK) government’s Budget,” Mr. Stalin said in a social media post.

According to him, the Budget had failed to present any far-sighted schemes for the State, and had not addressed the problems faced by farmers, issues relating to electricity consumption billing, or the rising cost of living.

Leader of the Opposition Udhayanidhi Stalin said the only change ushered in by the TVK government was the renaming of schemes introduced by the previous DMK government.

Referring to the Thaimaman Thangamothirai Scheme announced in the Budget, Mr. Udhayanidhi said it fell short of the Chief Minister’s election promise which, he claimed, was to extend the benefit to all children in Tamil Nadu. “Now, the Budget document says the scheme will be implemented only for children born in government hospitals,” he said.

Mr. Udhayanidhi said the Annal Ambedkar Business Champions Scheme, the Iyothey Thass Pandithar Habitation Scheme, and the Olympic Centres of Excellence were introduced during the DMK regime.



M.K. Stalin

“Anbu Cholai, a scheme for the welfare of senior citizens, has been renamed Integrated Senior Citizen Homes. Similarly, the Ulagam Ungal Kaiyil laptop distribution scheme has been renamed the Vetri Laptop Scheme, Kalaignar Kanavu Illam Thittam has become Vetri Veedu Thittam, Model Schools have been renamed Thagaisal Pallikal, and Mudhalvar Padaipagangal has been renamed Digital Noolagam,” he said.

DMK MLA and former Finance Minister Thangam Thennarasu said the figures contained in the Revised Budget Estimates had disproved the criticism levelled against the previous DMK government in the White Paper released by the TVK-led regime earlier.

He said the State’s annual borrowing was around ₹1 lakh crore during the DMK’s tenure, but had now increased to ₹1.22 lakh crore. “The capital expenditure has been reduced by ₹3,000 crore, while the revenue deficit has increased to ₹7,000 crore. Revenue expenditure, which stood at ₹3.39 lakh crore, has risen to ₹4.05 lakh crore,” he said.

INBRIEF



Trust to improve access to healthcare launched in city

Beyond Frontiers Trust (BFT), a non-profit organisation, was formally launched on Wednesday with the aim of improving access to specialist healthcare for tribal and underserved rural communities in Tamil Nadu. Founded by senior physician S.C. Chandilya, the Trust has been working in Jawadhu Hills, where geographical barriers and limited transport infrastructure often restrict access to specialised medical care. Addressing the launch event, Dr. Chandilya said the Trust seeks to provide specialist diagnosis and treatment to underserved tribal and rural populations. Shobana Kamineni, Promoter Director of Apollo Hospitals Enterprise Ltd. and Executive Chairperson of Apollo HealthCo Ltd, Jayshree Muralidharan, former IAS officer and Chairperson of Srinivasan Services Trust, and former IAS officer Swaran Singh, Chairman of TVS Cheema Scholarship Foundation spoke at the event.

Text & Context and Science

Weekday features on *The Hindu* epaper (epaper.thehindu.com) carry explainers, special articles and quizzes. In the latest issue (August 6, Thursday), the following articles are available:

- The road ahead for the Asiatic lion newsth.live/asiaticlion
- How excessive police force turns peaceful marches into medical crises newsth.live/policeexcesses

You can use your smartphone's inbuilt features to access these articles. If it's an Android phone, use Google Lens to read and tap the url to access an article. If it's an iPhone, use Live Text on camera to do the same.

Two women receive M.S. Swaminathan award for their efforts

While one awardee P. Pechiyammal pioneered in ghost gear collection, the other winner, Govindhammal, championed sustainable agriculture



Working for a cause: Winners of the Dr. M.S. Swaminathan Award for Environment Protection 2026 with dignitaries at the event in the city on Wednesday. R. RAGU

The Hindu Bureau CHENNAI

Two women – P. Pechiyammal, who has pioneered in ghost gear collection from Ramanathapuram, and Govindhammal who has championed sustainable agriculture from Villupuram – were honoured with Dr. M.S. Swaminathan Award for Environment Protection 2026 on Wednesday. They brought about changes in their communities.

Virendra Tiwari, Chairman, National Biodiversity Authority, who presented the awards, said that it was important to strike a balance between development and biodiversity. Sustainable agriculture

practices and keeping the sea plastic-free were commendable efforts.

The women who received the awards were immensely grateful to the foundation for assisting their communities in contributing towards environmental protection. “They (the communities) couldn't believe that I will get an award for just having collected wastes like old nets, nylon ropes, and other plastics from the shore,” said Ms. Pechiyammal. From a small farmer, who depended on the skies for water and got a few bags of produce, Ms. Govindhammal said she had risen to being a member of a Farmers Producer Company. “We were all like that, dependent on the rains. But

now we get good seeds and good rates for produce,” she said.

Soumya Swaminathan, chairperson, M.S. Swaminathan Research Foundation, thanked Rotary Club of Madras East (RI District 3234), and CavinKare Pvt. Ltd, for taking the effort to present the awards. She said that from last year a decision had been taken to award people from the grassroots. “Both fishing and agriculture are risky businesses which we don't realise because we get our grocery from stores. The women do it because it is the right thing to do,” she added. D. Suresh Jain, District Governor, RI District 3234, and Club president Radhika Sathyanarayana were present.

Experts highlight link between diabetes and vascular disease

The Hindu Bureau CHENNAI

The month of August marks the observance of vascular health awareness, and on the eve of Vascular Disease Awareness Day, which falls on August 6, doctors from Kauvery Hospital stressed the need to safeguard vascular health, a growing concern in India, in the light of its massive diabetes burden. The doctors were speaking at a webinar of *The Hindu* Wellness Series on ‘Vascular Health: Prevention, Healing and Limb Protection’ held on Wednesday.

N. Sekar, chief vascular and endovascular surgeon, Kauvery Hospital, Chennai, gave an overview of the need to understand vascular health and create awareness about it.

He explained the link between diabetes and vascular disease, noting that the length of time a person lived with diabetes increased the risk of vascular disease and highlighted that an amputation-free Tamil Nadu campaign was started to help bring down the number of amputations.

Arunagiri Viruthagiri, consultant vascular and endovascular surgeon, Kauvery Hospital, Tiruchi-Cantonment, delved into the details of the vascular structure in the human body – the network of blood

Two men held in connection with death of accountant

CHENNAI: The Anna Nagar police arrested two persons in connection with the death of S. Akash, 23, who fell from the fourth floor of a travel company in Anna Nagar on Saturday. The arrested persons were D. Senthilkumar and B. Diliepkumar. The police had earlier arrested Sugumar, owner of the firm. Police said Akash, an accountant at the firm, fell from the building after he was allegedly assaulted by three persons over alleged misappropriation of ₹40 lakh from the company's funds.

Chennai Weather	max	min
Tiruvallur	37	26
Chennai Airport	37	27
Chennai City	37	25

Chennai Airport Today
36°C The weather will be very warm and uneasy. Night will also be comfortable. Chances of light to moderate rain and thundershowers.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
35°C Morning will be comfortable. Day will be warm. Spell of light to moderate rain and thundershowers to occur.

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Timings CHENNAI			
THURSDAY, AUG. 06			
RISE	05:56	SET	18:34
RISE	00:00	SET	12:19
FRIDAY, AUG. 07			
RISE	05:56	SET	18:34
RISE	00:03	SET	13:21
SATURDAY, AUG. 08			
RISE	05:56	SET	18:34
RISE	00:59	SET	14:26

Government of Tamil Nadu ELECTRONICS CORPORATION TAMIL NADU LIMITED - ANGADI

9th Floor, Sigappi Aachi Building, 18/3, Rukmani Lakshmiipathi Road, Egmore, Chennai-600 008
<https://elcotangadi.tn.gov.in> [+91 44 2855 1234] tenders@elcotangadi.in

NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Tender No. E-ANGADI-RC-JT02-2026-0014

ELCOT Angadi invites “Rate Contract Tender for empanelment of vendors for supply, installation and commissioning of Bio-metric devices, SSL & DSC, Data card & Voice Sim, through ELCOT Angadi e-Commerce portal”. For complete details, please visit www.tntenders.gov.in. Pre-bid meeting: **11.08.2026, 11:00 AM** at ELCOT Nandanam Office. Last date for submission of e-bids: **03.09.2026, 3 PM**. For queries: tenders@elcotangadi.in.

DIPR/2463/Tender/2026 **GENERAL MANAGER (PROCUREMENT)**

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Or write to us at customercare@thehindu.co.in

Scan the QR code to register your feedback

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TAMILNADU CIVIL SUPPLIES CORPORATION
Head Office, CMRL Depot, Admin Building, Poonamalli High Road, Chennai - 600107
Ph No. (044) 26426773, E.mail ID : tnpsc.tn@nic.in
CIN: U15137TN1972SGC006157

SHORT E-TENDER NOTICE
Short e-tender No: BS4 /16600/2026/TNCS/26-27 Dt.05.08.2026

Online short e-tender is invited for the “ **PURCHASE OF 7.260 Bales of 5 PLY JUTE TWINE (WEIGHING 185 Kg. NETT PER BALE as per specifications.** ”

Complete short e-tender document can be viewed and downloaded through <https://tntenders.gov.in/nicgepl/app>

The bidders have to participate online bidding only with Digital Signature Certificate (DSC) of Class-II or Class-III

Last Date and Time for Online Submission : 21.08.2026 Upto 11.00 AM

DIPR /2464 / TENDER / 2026 **Managing Director**

NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF URBAN MANAGEMENT (NIUM), HYDERABAD

CORRIGENDUM - EXTENSION OF EO1 SUBMISSION DATE
With reference to EO1 No. NIUM-UP/5/1/2026-PH-NIUM dated **18.07.2026 for Empanelment of Consulting Firms/ Agencies** the last date for submission of applications has been **extended from 05.08.2026 (5:00 PM) to 12.08.2026 (5:00 PM)**. All other terms and conditions of the EO1 remain unchanged. For details, visit www.nium.org.in.
Sd/- Director General
DIPR R.O. No. : 393-P/CL-AGENCY/ADVT/2026-27 Dt:05-08-2026 **NIUM**

TAMILNADU CEMENTS CORPORATION LIMITED
(A GOVERNMENT OF TAMILNADU UNDERTAKING)
5th Floor, Avin Ilam, No.3A, Pasumpu Muthuramalingam Sala, Nandanam, Chennai-55

e-Tender Notice

e-Tender Ref. No.	Name of the Works	Est. value In Rs.	EMD In Rs.	Due Date
08/2026-27	Appointment of transport contractors for movement of packed cement through open trucks from various Cement Works, Ariyalur District to various destinations in Tamil Nadu, Pudukcherry and Kerala on rate contract basis.	44.94 crore	50,000	07.09.2026
09/2026-27	Appointment of transport contractors for movement of packed cement through open trucks from Ariyalur Cement Works, Virudhachari District to various destinations in Tamil Nadu and Kerala on rate contract basis.	5.38 crore	50,000	07.09.2026

Important Note: Pre-bid meetings for e.T.No:08 & 09/2026-27 will be held on 13.08.2026 at 3.00 & 3.30 PM respectively at TANCEN, Registered Office, 5th Floor, Avin Ilam, No.3A, Pasumpu Muthuramalingam Sala, Nandanam, Chennai-600 035. The tender document can be downloaded from <https://tntenders.gov.in>. Corrigendum /Addendum to this publication, if any would appear only on the above said website.
DIPR/2454/TENDER/2026 **General Manager Marketing / DRO**

THE HINDU

Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-;
Port Blair - Rs. 20/-

JHARKHAND RENEWABLE ENERGY DEVELOPMENT AGENCY (JREDA)
3rd Floor, SLDC Building, Kusai, Doranda, Ranchi- 834002. Ph. No: 2491161, Fax No: 0651-2491165
Web site: www.jreda.com, E-mail: info@jreda.com

e-Procurement Notice
Tender Reference No.: 14/JREDA/Misc. Services/26-27
Dated: 03.08.2026

Jharkhand Renewable Energy Development Agency (JREDA) is an autonomous body registered under the Societies Act, 1860, and is under the administrative control of the Department of Energy, Govt. of Jharkhand, for promoting the use of renewable energy sources, with its registered office at Kusai Colony, Doranda, Ranchi, Jharkhand-834002. JREDA requires a Rate Contract for Supply of Office Stationery Items, Cleaning Materials, IT Consumables, Computer Accessories, Printing Materials, Office Utility Items & Allied Services, Repair & Maintenance of Electrical & Electronics Items for its office operations and official requirements at its headquarters and other project locations in the State of Jharkhand.

Sl. No.	Particulars	Details
1	Name of the Work	Rate Contract for Supply of Miscellaneous Office Stationery Items, Cleaning Materials, IT Consumables, Computer Accessories, Printing Materials, Office Utility Items & Allied Miscellaneous Services, Repair & Maintenance of Electrical & Electronics Items to Jharkhand Renewable Energy Development Agency (JREDA).
2	Approx. for 1 Year Estimated Cost (in Rs.)	₹ 5,00,000/- (Five Lakhs Rupees Only) Inclusive of GST*
3	Earnest Money Deposit (Refundable) (In Rs.)	₹ 10,000/- (Ten Thousand Rupees Only)
4	Cost of Tender Document (Bid Fee) Non-Refundable (In Rs.)	₹ 1,475/- (Rupees One Thousand Four Hundred Seventy-five Only) Inclusive of GST
5	Contract Period	12 (Twelve) Months
6	Date of Publication of NIT on website:	05.08.2026 (Wednesday)
7	Date & Time of Pre-Bid Queries at JREDA Office	10.08.2026 (Monday) up to 02:00 PM
8	Last Date & Time for Receipt of Online Bids	27.08.2026 (Thursday) up to 05:00 PM
9	Submission of Bid Fee & EMD (Online via SBI Payment Gateway of Jharkhand Tenders)	27.08.2026 (Thursday) up to 05:00 PM
10	Technical Bid Opening Date	01.09.2026 (Tuesday) at 03:00 PM
11	Name & Address of Office Inviting Tender	Director, Jharkhand Renewable Energy Development Agency (JREDA), 3rd Floor, SLDC Building, Kusai Colony, Doranda, Ranchi-834002
12	Contact No. of Procurement Officer	0651-2491161 / 63 / 67
13	Helpline No. of e-Procurement	0651-2491161 / 63 / 67

Any corrigendum/addendum can be seen on the website: <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> & www.jreda.com. Further details can be seen on the website: <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> & www.jreda.com.

Sd/
Director, JREDA, Ranchi

PR.NO.386673 Energy(26-27):D

अखिल भारतीय आयुर्विज्ञान संस्थान (अ.भा.आ.सं.), भुवनेश्वर
ALL INDIA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES (AIIMS), BHUBANESWAR
(A Statutory body under aegis of Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, Govt. of India)
Sijua, Post-Dumuduma, Bhubaneswar (Odisha) -751019

File No. RECT-11014/3/2026-RECU SEC Dated: 05-08-2026

NOTIFICATION
ADVT. NO. - DEPUTATION/02/2026

Sub-Recruitment of various Group 'A', 'B' and 'C' posts on Deputation Basis at AIIMS Bhubaneswar.
All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Bhubaneswar, an Autonomous Institute of National Importance, is one of the newer AIIMS and an apex healthcare Institute established by the Ministry of Health & Family Welfare, Government of India, under the Pradhan Mantri Swasthya Suraksha Yojana (PMSSY) with the aim of correcting regional imbalances in quality tertiary level healthcare in the country and attaining self-sufficiency in undergraduate, postgraduate & higher medical education, research and training.

Applications are being invited in prescribed pro-forma (Hard Copy Only) from eligible officials of Central / State / U.T. Governments / Statutory / Autonomous Bodies / Government Universities / Government Research and Development Organizations etc. as applicable to fill the below mentioned various Group 'A', 'B' and 'C' posts on Deputation Basis at All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Bhubaneswar.

Sl.	Name Of the Post	Group	Pay Scale as per 7th	Vacancy
1.	Medical Superintendent	A	Level 14 + NPA	1
2.	Chief Librarian	A	Level 13	1
3.	Registrar	A	Level 12	1
4.	Senior Analyst (System Analyst)	A	Level 12	1
5.	Chief Nursing Officer	A	Level 12	1
6.	Senior Administrative Officer	A	Level 11	1
7.	Senior Procurement Cum Store Officer	A	Level 11	1
8.	Nursing Superintendent	A	Level 11	3
9.	Chief Dietician	A	Level 11	1
10.	Chief Medical Social Service Officer	A	Level 11	1
11.	CSSD Officer	A	Level 11	1
12.	Principle Private Secretary	A	Level 11	1
13.	Librarian Selection Grade (Senior Librarian)	A	Level 11	1
14.	Chief Medical Record Officer	A	Level 10	1
15.	Private Secretary	B	Level 7	3
16.	Chief Pharmacist	B	Level 7	1
17.	Senior Sanitation Officer	B	Level 7	1
18.	Manager/ Supervisor/ Gas Officer	B	Level 7	1
19.	Junior Administrative Officer	B	Level 6	9
20.	Sr. Pharmacist	B	Level 6	3
21.	Pharmacist Grade I	B	Level 6	11
22.	Medical Record Officer	B	Level 6	4
23.	Sanitation Officer	B	Level 6	3
24.	Personal Assistant	B	Level 6	6
25.	Senior Administrative Assistant (UDC)	C	Level 4	3
Total				61

For comprehensive details regarding the eligibility criteria, essential educational qualification, age and other terms & conditions, please refer to **Advt No. DEPUTATION/2/2026 Dated 04.08.2026**, available on the Institute's official website <https://aiimsbhubaneswar.nic.in>

Sd/-
(Md. Salim Golder)
Administrative Officer
AIIMS, Bhubaneswar

Recruitment Notice
DAKSH Innovation and Incubation Centre (DIIC)-UPSIFS Foundation
Uttar Pradesh State Institute of Forensic Science, Lucknow
Aurawan, Daroga Kheda, P.O. Banthra, Lucknow - 226401
(Walk-in Interview)

Advertisement No- DIIC/01/2026
DAKSH Innovation and Incubation Centre (DIIC)-UPSIFS Foundation, invites applications for following post in on contractual basis. UPSIFS Lucknow (Established in 2021) is a flagship Institution functioning under the aegis of the Home Department, Govt. of U.P.

Post	Remunerations/ month	Post	Remunerations/ month
Chief Executive Officer (CEO)	₹ 1,50,000	Startup Coordinator	₹ 45,000
Incubation In-charge/Officer	₹ 70,000		
Incubation Faculty Coordinator	₹ 65,000	Office Executive	₹ 25,000

For more details, please visit website www.upsifs.ac.in.
Mail your CV to ceo@upsifs.org.
The last date was 02-08-2026 which has been extended till 16-08-2026 and interview will be on 21-08-2026

UPID Ro.: 254489
R.O. Dt: 05/08/2026
Website: www.up.gov.in

Director
DIIC-UPSIFS FOUNDATION

PONDICHERY UNIVERSITY
(A Central University)
Centre for Distance and Online Education (Formerly DDE)
(Programmes Approved by DEB, UGC, New Delhi)

NAAC A+ GRADE

ADMISSIONS OPEN 2026-27

MBA PROGRAMMES (2 YEARS - SEMESTER PATTERN)

- MBA - Marketing
- MBA - Finance
- MBA - International Business
- MBA - General
- MBA - Operations & Supply Chain Management
- MBA - Human Resource Management
- MBA - Tourism
- MBA - Hospital Management

PG PROGRAMMES (2 YEARS - SEMESTER PATTERN)

- MA (English)
- MA (Hindi)
- MA (Sociology)
- M.Com (Finance)

CERTIFICATE COURSES

- Certificate course in Tax and Corporate Compliance
- Certificate course in Research and Publication Ethics
- Certificate course in Research Data analysis Using AI
- Certificate course in Generative AI
- Certificate course in Agentic AI
- Certificate course in Music Therapy
- Certificate Course in Music Composition

UG PROGRAMMES (4 YEARS - SEMESTER PATTERN)

- BBA (HONS)
- B.Com (HONS)
- BA English (HONS)
- BA Sociology (HONS)

ELIGIBILITY FOR PG PROGRAMMES
Any Graduate with MBBS degree, Pharmacy, Dental, Nursing, Physiotherapy, Bio-Engineering, Bio-Sciences [or] A Graduate from any of the Indian Systems of Medicine (Ayurveda, Siddha, Unani, Yoga) or Any other graduate with 2 years of Work Experience in any hospital and the degree should be from a UGC Recognised University with pass in the stream of B.A. 2+3 or B.Sc 1+3 or B.A 1+2+2 system.

ELIGIBILITY FOR UG PROGRAMMES
The student must have passed in any of the stream of 10+2 or 11+1 or 11+1+2 system.

SPECIAL FEATURES UNDER DISTANCE MODE

- Degree from a Central University
- E-Learning Resources & Digital Study Material
- Admission through Online

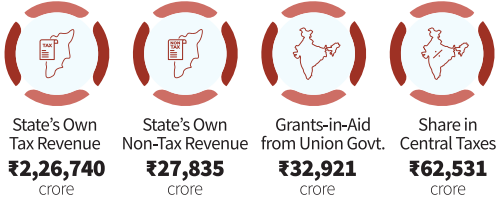
APPLY ON OR BEFORE 15 SEPTEMBER 2026

Website : <https://dde.pondicherryuniversity.ac.in>
Email : ddehelpdesk@pondicherryuniversity.ac.in
Phone No: 0413-265439/440

T.N. BUDGET

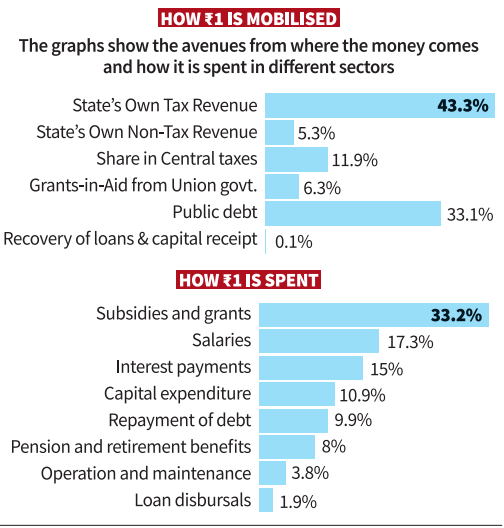
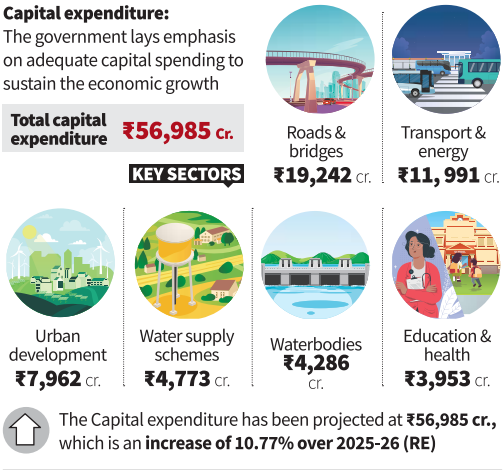
Earnings & outgo

State's revenue: In the Revised Budget 2026-27, the T.N. govt. has projected its revenue receipts at **₹3,50,027 cr.** Of this, the State's Own Revenue constitutes 72.73%, while 27.27% comes from its Share in Central taxes and Grants-in-Aid from the Union government



State's expenditure: The total expenditure of the State government is projected at **₹4,72,585 crore** in the Revised Budget 2026-2027, which is an **increase of 8.52% over 2025-26 (RE)**

The lion's share: A major portion of the revenue expenditure is spent on various welfare schemes for the people, especially the poor and vulnerable



Govt. to give one-sovereign gold coin, silk saree to brides

'Aran' shelter homes will be set up in 5 districts to provide safe accommodation, food, counselling, and rehabilitation support to transpersons who face social challenges, says State Finance Minister

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu government will present an eight-gram (one-sovereign) gold coin and a silk saree as 'Annan Seer' (Elder Brother's Gift) to eligible women on the day of their wedding, Finance Minister Marie Wilson announced in the Assembly on Wednesday. An allocation of ₹812 crore has been made in the Revised Budget Estimates for the scheme, which was among the election promises of the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam.

Reiterating the State government's commitment to transforming Tamil Nadu into an elder-friendly State by ensuring a life of dignity, graceful ageing, and comprehensive social security for senior citizens, the Minister told the Assembly that an integrated home for senior citizens, equipped with essential amenities including qualified caregivers, medical personnel, and recreational facilities, would be established in all districts.

In the first year, 12 such homes will be set up in 12 districts, each accommodating 40 beneficiaries, at an allocation of ₹6.6 crore. Additionally, senior citizens' recreation centres



Keeping a promise: An allocation of ₹812 crore has been made in the Revised Budget Estimates for the 'Annan Seer' scheme, which was among the assurances in the TVK's manifesto. REPRESENTATIONAL PHOTO

featuring libraries, yoga and meditation facilities, and indoor sports amenities will be established in five districts in the initial phase.

The Minister said the government would construct 500 Anganwadi centres during the current financial year, ensuring the provision of essential basic amenities such as safe drinking water, toilets, and electricity.

To support the transgender community in achieving socio-economic empowerment, Mr. Wilson

said skill training will be provided in various income-generating trades through the Tamil Nadu Skill Development Corporation. "Along with this, subsidy-

linked bank credit facilities will be extended to enable them to establish enterprises and secure sustainable livelihoods. They will also be assisted in availing themselves of bank loans for self-employment, with a subsidy of up to ₹50,000," he said. He announced that the government will establish 'Aran'

shelter homes in five districts to provide safe accommodation, food, counselling, and rehabilitation support to transpersons facing social and family-related challenges.

Short-stay homes
In addition, short-stay homes will be established in 15 districts to meet the needs of transgender persons travelling to other cities for education, employment, medical treatment, examinations, and training programmes. An allocation of ₹9,818 crore was made for the Social Welfare and Women's Empowerment Department.

T.N. increases Haj subsidy to ₹35,000 for first-time pilgrims

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Finance Minister N. Marie Wilson said on Wednesday that the subsidy provided by the Tamil Nadu State Hajj Committee to the first-time Haj pilgrims would be increased from ₹25,000 to ₹35,000.

Presenting the Revised Budget for 2026-27, he said the government had allocated ₹372 crore for pre-matric and post-matric educational scholarships, ₹77 crore towards the tuition fees of students pursuing medicine and dentistry under the 7.5% reservation, and ₹13.41 crore as incentives for girl students to prevent school dropouts. The aim was to ensure that students of the Backward Classes, the Most Backward Classes and the De-notified Communities pursued school and higher education without hindrance.

Additional Christian and Muslim Women Aid Societies would be formed with an allocation of ₹1.05 crore, while ₹34 crore had been allocated in the Revised Budget Estimates to improve the infrastructure of burial grounds and kabrasthans, he said. The State government had allocated ₹1,700 crore for the Department of Backward Classes, Most Backward Classes, and Minorities Welfare.

The Department for the Welfare of Differently Abled Persons had been allocated ₹1,485 crore.

Financial assistance of up to 50% of the cost of equipment, subject to a maximum of ₹30,000, would be provided for purchasing modern AI-based assistive devices not covered under the existing assistive devices distribution scheme, he said.

The Finance Minister said government institutions for persons with intellectual disabilities, named 'Nambikkai Illam', will be established in Thanjavur, Tiruvannamalai, Salem, Cuddalore, and Virudhunagar districts. These institutions would provide special education, early intervention services, rehabilitation, and vocational training to children aged three and above. Initially, each institution would function as a day school with 50 students before being furnished with residential facilities. An amount of ₹4 crore had been allocated for this purpose.

Mr. Wilson added: "A new 'Rooftop Solar Subsidy Scheme' will be introduced in convergence with the 'Pradhan Mantri Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana'. Under this scheme, a subsidy of up to ₹1 lakh will be provided to domestic consumers for installing solar panels."

SNIPPETS



CM called 'Jananayagan' and 'Vijay Mama' in Budget speech

Finance Minister N. Marie Wilson on Wednesday described Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay as a 'Jananayagan' (the title of his last film) during the Budget speech in the Assembly. He said that, within just three months of assuming office, the Chief Minister had earned an enduring place in the hearts of the people, becoming part of every household as a son, an elder brother, a younger brother, their very life, their kin and the embodiment of their emotions. Elsewhere in his speech, the Minister referred to the Chief Minister as 'Vijay Mama' (Uncle Vijay) to children. He said the Chief Minister had entered public life solely to repay his debt of gratitude to the people who had given him everything. "He overcame numerous conspiracies to secure a historic victory, for the sake of the people whom he loves as his own life," he added.

Finance Minister carries rosary, makes sign of the cross

Finance Minister N. Marie Wilson, who presented the Revised Budget Estimates 2026-27 on Wednesday, entered the Assembly carrying a rosary and began his speech by making the sign of the cross. His attire also differed from that of his predecessors, who traditionally wore dhotis. Mr. Wilson was dressed in trousers and a tucked-in shirt with button tabs to secure the rolled-up sleeves.

Budget session to continue till September 8, says Speaker

Tamil Nadu Assembly Speaker J.C.D. Prabhakar said on Wednesday that the Budget session of the Assembly would continue till September 8. The entire proceedings would be telecast live, he added. Addressing journalists after the Business Advisory Committee (BAC) meeting, he said the Revised Agriculture Budget for 2026-27 would be presented on Thursday. The general discussion on the Revised Budget and Revised Agriculture Budget Estimates for 2026-27 would begin on the same day and continue on August 10, 11, and 12.

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Tamil Nadu Finance Minister N. Marie Wilson said on Wednesday that the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK)-led government had so far signed seven memoranda of understanding (MoUs), worth ₹35,062 crore, with the potential to create 14,790 direct and indirect jobs.

Presenting the Revised Budget for 2026-27, he said India's first dedicated artificial intelligence (AI) and innovation city, named 'Arivagam', would be established for AI and deep-tech development, with facilities including an AI university, an international skill development centre, a semiconductor hardware testing lab, multi-domain

innovation incubators, and modern residential infrastructure. A feasibility study for the project would be undertaken at an estimated cost of ₹5 crore.

To encourage large-scale investment and accelerate industrial growth, the government would strive to establish more Multi Modal Logistics Parks (MMLPs) and Dry Ports at strategic locations and petrochemical and ancillary industries, and explore the possibility of setting up new ports.

According to the Minister, Thoothukudi and Tirunelveli will be declared a 'Space Industrial Investment Zone', anchored by the strategic significance of the spaceport at Kulasekaraipattinam. To provide infrastructure and techno-



Promoting innovation: The 'Arivagam' will be established for AI and deep-tech development, with facilities including an international skill development centre. GETTY IMAGES

logical support to private enterprises, start-ups, and research organisations, the government, in collaboration with IN-SPACe, will establish an advanced 'Space Vehicle Common Technical Facility'.

A new Tamil Nadu Industrial Policy would be re-

leased to strengthen the State's industrial and economic growth. It would foster innovation and technology-driven growth, support emerging industry sectors, drive sustainable development, and export promotion. The government would also create the

Assistance given to fishermen during lean period raised to ₹7,000 per family

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu government will increase lean-period fishing assistance for traditional fishermen from ₹6,000 to ₹7,000 per family on an allocation of ₹135 crore. This will benefit 1.93 lakh traditional fishermen families, Finance Minister N. Marie Wilson said on Wednesday.

Presenting the Revised Budget for 2026-27, Mr. Wilson said to encourage traditional fishermen to take up deep-sea fishing, financial assistance in the form of interest subsidy would be given to those purchasing deep-sea fishing boats equipped with modern processing facilities. A sum of ₹12 crore had been allocated for the scheme.

The Minister also announced that under 'Vetri Magalir Goat Rearing Scheme', five goats or



A sum of ₹12 crore has been allocated to provide interest subsidy to traditional fishermen who purchase deep-sea fishing boats.

sheep would be provided with a 100% subsidy to destitute widows, deserted women, transgender persons, and persons with disabilities living in rural areas. The scheme would benefit about 30,000 persons at a cost of ₹110 crore. A total of 41 new buildings required for veterinary hospitals would be constructed at a cost of ₹47 crore.

To meet the medical treatment needs of lives-

tock, 25 veterinary hospitals would be upgraded as veterinary polyclinics and 210 veterinary dispensaries would be upgraded as veterinary hospitals at a cost of ₹40 crore. Furthermore, 143 new mobile veterinary units would be established at a cost of ₹35 crore, Mr. Wilson said.

The government would introduce a new livestock insurance scheme, named 'Kaalnadaigal Kaappom', to provide financial protec-

tion against the loss of livestock, due to unforeseen mortality, disease or disaster, at a cost of ₹31 crore, he said. To ensure that farmers received quality feed at a lower price, the government would establish fodder seed banks and depots across the State at a cost of ₹6.70 crore. An amount of ₹13 crore had been allocated to promote green fodder cultivation, improve the use of chaffed fodder, and restore grazing land through community participation.

Besides, to increase milk production and secure the livelihood of women living in rural areas, milch cows would be provided free of cost to 10,000 eligible women every year, and ₹57 crore had been allocated for the initiative. The Animal Husbandry, Dairying, Fisheries and Fishermen Welfare Department has been allocated ₹4,880 crore.

₹708 crore allocated to consecrate 3,000 temples over 5 years

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu government plans to undertake renovation and perform 'Thirukudamuzhukku' (consecration) at 3,000 temples and restore 84 temple cars over the next five years, Finance Minister N. Marie Wilson said on Wednesday.

Presenting the Revised Budget Estimates in the Assembly, he said the government would also upgrade basic amenities at temples that attracted a large number of devotees by providing safe drinking water, restrooms, bathrooms, accommodation, and other infrastructure.

An allocation of ₹708 crore has been made for the Hindu Religious and Charitable Endowments (HR&CE) Department in the Revised Budget Esti-

Restoration and conservation are also being carried out at 213 temples that are more than 1,000 years old

mates. He said the government had recognised the need to appoint trustees to temples and issued notification for the appointment of trustees to 9,205 temples within a short span. Action was under way to complete the process.

Restoration and conservation were also being carried out at 213 temples that are over 1,000 years old at an estimated cost of ₹418 crore. Besides introducing structural reforms in the department, the government was focusing on safeguarding the movable and immovable properties of the temples, he added.



Highs and lows

GST must be fuelled by domestic production, not inflation or imports

That GST grossed ₹2.11 lakh crore in July, expanding by 15.4% year-on-year, the second best growth in FY27, could indicate that the Indian economy is resilient. But it conceals the uneven internal and external trajectories, and disparities within India. The 26.9% growth in import IGST *vis-à-vis* a 4.5% rise in domestic revenues ferrets out the criticality in the trade-led tax buoyancy. IGST's faster pickup started during the post-pandemic recovery, reflective of global commodity inflation, higher imports of capital goods and the rupee's depreciation. A 10%-12% depreciation of the Indian denomination over the past year had its reflection on the rupee cost of crude oil, electronics, machinery and chemicals – they collectively constitute as much as 50% of total imports – contributing to a higher import bill. Although gold imports added to higher IGST collections, supply fell to a six-year low, due to lower bullion imports, which fell 22%. High WPI inflation, notably at the manufacturing level, at 7.18% this June against 1.52% a year-ago period, explains the traction of domestic revenues in an ad valorem tax system amid five-year low manufacturing growth as seen from the HSBC Manufacturing PMI. The services witnessed slowest growth in 53 months with real estate and business services recording the strongest rise in charges, but the sector's GST buoyancy is concentrated geographically.

The fiscal reality is that only 16 States/UTs have reported post-settlement GST growth exceeding the national average and a little over a dozen States saw higher than average growth in GST, showing an increasingly chequered path as manufacturing and organised services are concentrated in a few jurisdictions; others, especially those with a larger unorganised sector, struggle to generate tax buoyancy, becoming dependent on central transfers and Finance Commission devolution. GST 3.0 should ensure that the benefits of economic expansion are geographically broad-based and fiscally inclusive. The faster domestic refunds, in comparison to IGST refunds, imply that formal businesses are expanding their GST compliance and also carrying larger credit balances as the government improved the GST ecosystem, even as faultlines such as input tax credit disputes and litigation are yet to be resolved. The July numbers warrant a closer reading as a healthy GST trajectory should reflect domestic production, growing incomes and broad-based consumption rather than exchange-rate-induced gains in import taxation and piggyback riding on local inflation. Otherwise 'Make in India' remains a tall claim as imported inputs do much of the heavy lifting in the GST metrics.

Quantum shift

Private R&D spends should be used to bolster manufacturing

The Department of Science and Technology's latest figures on India's research profile record a milestone. In 2023-24, private industry accounted for 51.8% of national research spending – a first in India's history – overtaking all tiers of government combined for the first time. Moreover, industry now employs more core researchers than government institutions. Transport firms are the largest corporate investors, followed by pharmaceuticals, biotechnology and information technology (IT). The break from the past is sharp. Through the 2010s, private industry contributed a little over a third of national R&D, and the ratio moved slowly. Then, between 2020-21 and 2021-22, private spending nearly doubled – from ₹46,388 crore to ₹82,975 crore – and total R&D jumped from ₹1.27 lakh crore to ₹1.95 lakh crore in a single year. R&D spends in the transport sector, which barely registered before 2020, has roughly tripled and leads the triumvirate that includes biotechnology and IT that are counted among India's most research-intensive industries.

Officials attribute this to a post-pandemic realisation that research is essential to competitiveness, and that may be part of the story. The purported investments for '23-'25 also look healthy, but a change concentrated in one year looks less like a shift in corporate behaviour and more like a change in what is counted. Mandatory sustainability disclosures for large listed firms, and tighter RBI norms on reporting research, took effect at the same moment. Spending that was always occurring – in the foreign subsidiaries of Indian companies, and in the captive centres of multinationals – is only now being fully captured. Some of the surge, in other words, reflects better measurement rather than more money. Genuinely new capital is flowing too – into artificial intelligence, chip design and semiconductor fabs – though much of that is still infrastructure building and may not yet belong in the R&D column. India's R&D stands at 0.84% of GDP, against 2.58% for China, 3.45% for the U.S. and 4.94% for South Korea; it fields 354 researchers per million people where South Korea and Israel field several thousand. The private sector's own priorities are a further reason for caution: more was spent on advertising than on research in 2023-24. The shift will prove worthwhile if it deepens India's pool of specialised workers and its capacity for sophisticated manufacturing, carrying the economy beyond its long reliance on supplying low-cost services. That depends less on how spending is recorded than on how many researchers the country can train. The Anusandhan National Research Foundation, with a ₹50,000-crore corpus largely to be raised from private sources, was created for precisely this purpose. Its promise now rests on delivery.

The Finance Commission, an institutional innovation embedded in India's constitutional architecture, was never intended to be a routine allocator of funds. It was designed as a central pillar of India's fiscal federal compact and as a corrective institution that would mediate the inherent asymmetry between a fiscally dominant Union and structurally constrained States, while also addressing deep horizontal inequalities arising from history, geography, and institutional capacity. In a country marked by uneven development at Independence, the Commission's central mandate was to safeguard the interests of the States and thereby preserve a strong Union.

Each successive Commission, cognisant of its historical context, has interpreted this mandate in its own way, yet all have contributed to sustaining India's fiscal federal compact. The recently submitted report of the 16th Finance Commission (FC-16), chaired by Arvind Panagariya and covering the period 2026-31, marks a decisive turning point. While it retains the vertical devolution of central taxes to the States at 41%, it fundamentally re-engineers the structure of fiscal transfers, particularly grants-in-aid. In doing so, it prioritises efficiency and performance but raises serious concerns about equity and constitutional intent. At the heart of the issue lies a deeper question: has the Commission moved away from its equalising role toward one that implicitly protects the Union's fiscal primacy?

The constitutional logic of grants-in-aid Evidently, the provision for grants-in-aid under Article 275 was not an afterthought; it was a foundational design element. In a country more diverse than any other in the world, tax devolution, however sophisticated its formula, cannot account for the diversity of State-specific needs. For instance, Kerala's "export-oriented" human capital development strategy has accounted for nearly 23% of India's total remittances, thereby strengthening the country's external sector. However, this has come at a cost to the State's fiscal health, as it has had to rely on borrowing to finance investments in education.

Similarly, Punjab has played a critical role in ensuring national food security, but at the cost of its revenue base, by focusing on the production of wheat and rice, which are non-taxable apart from paying the price of being a border State. The same is true of the hill States, which face high infrastructure costs; the north-eastern States, which grapple with connectivity constraints; and fiscally stressed States burdened by demographic pressures and social sector commitments.

Grants-in-aid were therefore conceived as instruments of equalisation, enabling targeted support for States with special needs where formula-based tax devolution falls short. The F-14



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The Sixteenth Finance Commission risks moving away from its core mandate of acting as an equalising force within the federation

and the FC-15 recognised this reality by retaining Revenue Deficit Grants (RDGs), sector-specific grants, and State-specific grants.

The FC-16 departs sharply from this tradition. It recommends grants-in-aid of ₹9.47 lakh crore, compared with ₹10.1 lakh crore under the FC-15, while their share in total Finance Commission transfers has more than halved, from 19.4% to 8.3%. By restricting grants-in-aid to local bodies and disaster management, it eliminates RDGs, sector-specific grants, and State-specific grants.

While retaining the States' share in the divisible pool at 41%, despite the demand from 18 States to raise it to 50%, the Commission presumes that improved fiscal discipline should enable States to manage their finances without additional gap-filling transfers. However, this reasoning rests on a problematic assumption: that fiscal capacity across States is sufficiently uniform for devolution to be self-equalising.

Empirically and historically, this assumption is untenable. The Commission's justification for doing away with RDGs is rooted in concerns about fiscal prudence. It argues that RDGs create moral hazard by incentivising States to underperform in revenue mobilisation or overspend in the expectation of central support.

It also points to aggregate data suggesting that the States, taken as a whole, are not in severe fiscal distress. Yet, this aggregate view masks deep inter-State disparities, with some States remaining fiscally stressed despite contributing disproportionately to national development and continuing to require fiscal assistance. The very purpose of RDGs was to recognise this heterogeneity, as a fiscal surplus in one State cannot offset a fiscal deficit in another.

More troubling is the contrast between the Commission's stance on RDGs and its treatment of cesses and surcharges. While advocating fiscal discipline for States through the withdrawal of RDGs, it stops short of recommending any binding rollback of these non-shareable union levies ignoring the demand by many States.

Dual shift

Instead, it proposes a "grand bargain", whereby the Centre would gradually merge cesses into the divisible pool in exchange for States accepting a lower devolution share. This asymmetry is difficult to overlook. RDGs are removed in the name of discipline, yet cesses – arguably a more distortionary instrument from a federal perspective – are only gently nudged toward reform. The resulting framework imposes stringency on States while preserving fiscal flexibility for the Union. This dual shift, protecting Union revenues while constraining State support, raises a fundamental concern: is the Commission inadvertently reinforcing vertical imbalance rather than correcting it?

The consequences are particularly severe for

States that already face structural disadvantages. As many as eight States, including most of the disadvantaged north-eastern States and fiscally stressed West Bengal, are set to experience a reduced share in both tax devolution and grants-in-aid, while another six States have seen a decline in their share of grants. The problem is further compounded by the reduction in the weight assigned to income distance (from 45% to 42.5%) and the introduction of a 10% weight for contribution to GDP. When combined with the removal of the RDGs, which accounted for about 20% of Finance Commission grants in 2024-25, this creates a double burden: lower tax devolution and the absence of compensatory grants. The Commission's implicit assumption that efficiency should trump equity risks widening regional disparities.

Another defining feature of the FC-16 is its emphasis on tied and performance-based grants, particularly for local governments. While the allocation of nearly ₹7.2 lakh crore to the third tier is commendable, the conditionalities attached to these grants are stringent, linking the release of funds to targets in water and sanitation, revenue mobilisation, and audited accounts. This approach promotes accountability, but it also reduces fiscal autonomy. In effect, the architecture of grants shifts from need-based equalisation to compliance-based incentivisation. Fiscal discipline, while necessary, cannot substitute for fiscal justice.

Efficiency versus equity

The FC-16's report is bold in ambition but uneven in balance. The dismantling of the RDGs and the shift toward performance-based transfers reflect a technocratic confidence in market-like incentives, even though fiscal federalism is a political and constitutional arrangement designed to manage diversity. The contrast between the Commission's strict stance on RDGs and its accommodative approach to cesses and surcharges, along with its hesitation to raise the States' share in the divisible pool to 50% despite demands from several States, reveals a deeper tension.

It suggests a framework that, intentionally or otherwise, protects the fiscal space of the Union while placing a greater adjustment burden on the States. In doing so, the Commission may have moved away from its core mandate of acting as an equalising force within the federation. If the Finance Commission is to continue playing its historic role in holding India together, future Commissions must reward high-performing States while supporting those that continue to face structural disadvantages.

For a country as diverse as India, fiscal federalism cannot be sustained on performance alone; it must be anchored in fairness.

The views expressed are personal

A climate resilience pathway between India and China

This year, El Niño delayed the monsoon in India. When the rains arrived, they were intense, with cities such as Mumbai and Surat receiving a month's rainfall in a matter of days. Regions in Assam and Odisha have experienced severe flooding, resulting in loss of life and damage to infrastructure. Similar conditions have recently affected large swathes of China's provinces, particularly Guangxi, Shaanxi and Gansu. Such extreme weather events are becoming increasingly common, threatening economic growth, food security, and public well-being in the two most populous countries.

In both cases, experts attribute these short, high-intensity bursts to climate change which is causing higher atmospheric temperatures and rapidly warming oceans. Mitigating and recovering from these frequent and large-scale events will become increasingly important for China and India to address. Given the scale of the challenge, could climate resilience become an opening for India-China cooperation?

Similar climate extremes

India and China confront remarkably similar challenges. Rapid urbanisation has replaced wetlands, forests, and permeable surfaces with concrete. Changing weather patterns, combined with outdated drainage systems, poor waste management, rapid urbanisation, and a lack of green spaces, have aggravated waterlogging and flooding. Coastal megacities face the combined risks of extreme precipitation, storm surges, and sea-level rise, while inland cities grapple with heatwaves, droughts, and flash floods occurring in quick succession. These challenges demand scientific collaboration, technological innovation, stronger local governance, and community participation. The costs of inaction include disrupted supply chains, economic losses, declining productivity, and mounting public health risks. This may be the right moment for renewed engagement between India and China. After years of strained ties, bilateral relations are showing tentative and slow signs of improvement.



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Shared climate challenges create opportunities for India-China cooperation

In April 2026, the visit by a Chinese delegation led by China's Special Envoy for Climate Change to New Delhi suggests that climate cooperation remains a priority. Within the area of climate and clean energy, identifying key issues for engagement is important. Collaboration in areas such as green technology and critical minerals remains challenging due to economic competition and geopolitical tensions. Disaster mitigation and urban resilience could offer a relatively low-risk pathway for rebuilding trust.

Past engagement, sister city agreements

A mapping of India and China's climate engagement in a recent paper by the Centre for Social and Economic Progress (CSEP) shows that there is precedent for such engagement. Beginning from the early 1990s until 2020, there were several summit-level joint statements, agreements and Memoranda of Understanding (MoUs) calling for practical cooperation on climate change. Topics included climate-induced disasters such as floods, earthquake, droughts and extreme weather events. These MoUs promised facilitation of joint research and development, hydrological, oceanic and seismic data sharing, and exchange of governance practices. During the six Strategic Economic Dialogues, policymakers discussed sustainable urban planning, waste management, sewage treatment, water efficiency and capacity building.

Practical implementation of joint projects in these areas was formally agreed upon in the multiple sister city agreements – Delhi-Beijing, Mumbai-Shanghai, and Chennai-Chongqing. Yet, disruptions in diplomatic engagement resulted in little on-ground action.

China demonstrates the importance of embedding resilience into core urban and rural planning investment decisions. This includes using data-driven approaches to drive policies in transport, housing and drainage systems. India's strength lies in adaptive governance, spearheading community-led strategies for targeted interventions in vulnerable populations.

Successes in India have been seen in early warning systems, heat action plans, cool roofs and nature-based solutions. There has to be engagement between state and non-state actors. Officials from municipal governments can enable knowledge and policy exchanges on urban design such as sponge cities, drainage modernisation and waste management.

Beyond urban issues, rural livelihoods and resilient agricultural practices for food security become salient points for mutual learning. Joint collaboration between planning agencies and academic institutions can improve systems for hydrological modelling and integrating regional and indigenous knowledge into climate adaptation strategies. A critical aspect will be addressing challenges of the melting glacial systems in the shared Himalayan ecosystem. While India and China had agreements on shared water resources, they ceased to function in 2022.

The finance gap

A major barrier to climate adaptation remains financing, with both countries relying heavily on public funds to carry out their policies. Bridging this gap requires greater private sector participation through tools such as blended finance, municipal bonds, and credit enhancement. However, these are nascent ecosystems, constrained by limited local capacity and regulatory gaps. Evidence-based studies and knowledge exchanges between India and China on these models could provide an innovative avenue for engagement. Such cooperation would not only benefit both countries but also enable them to shape climate resilience norms across the Global South through stronger standards, metrics, and fiscal frameworks.

Climate change impacts transcend national borders, from Europe's heatwaves to Asia's heavy monsoon floods. Greater coordination and cooperation could provide India and China with a pathway for a low-risk, win-win engagement.

The views expressed are personal

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Language in politics

Recent developments in political discourse across India, particularly in Tamil Nadu, underscore the need for restraint, dignity, and moderation in public debate. Language is the apparel of democracy. If democracy is the best form of governance, it must be

protected, nurtured, and enriched. The language used in public life reflects one's commitment to democratic values.

K.S.S. Seshan,
Errepalle, Andhra Pradesh

As a septuagenarian, I have witnessed many changes in our country over the

decades — some for the better, others for the worse. Among the latter, one of the most disturbing has been the steady decline in the quality of public discourse in recent years, particularly among our political leaders. With millions watching them every day on television and social media,

political leaders ought to realise that their words and conduct shape public behaviour. It is therefore unsurprising that coarse, intemperate, and abusive language has gradually become normalised in our society. Sharp exchanges between the treasury benches and

the Opposition are an integral part of any vibrant democracy. But when political discourse descends into vile personal attacks, drags family members into political battles, pries into private lives, or levels unsubstantiated allegations of moral turpitude, it demeans public life and

weakens democratic values. Those who sow the wind of abuse should not complain when they reap the whirlwind of retaliation.

G.P. Menon,
Tripurithura, Kerala

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address and the full name.

YSRCP's search for political momentum

Did abrogating special status for J&K make a difference?

Undelivered promises

FROM THE ARCHIVES

The  Kinda.

FIFTY YEARS AGO AUGUST 6, 1976

More students fancy snuff

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO AUGUST 6, 1926

A military revolt in Goa

Protests stall Parliament for 13th consecutive day

Houses witness repeated disruptions over donation theft and police action against protesters; Lok Sabha passes Bankers' Books Evidence Bill without debate; Rijiju slams MPs for staging skits

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Disruptions continued in both Houses of Parliament for the 13th consecutive day on Wednesday, with the Opposition persisting in its protests over the alleged Ram Temple donation scam and its demand for a statement from Union Home Minister Amit Shah on last month's police action against protesters.

The government has not extended any assurance on either issue.

In the Lok Sabha, Opposition MPs trooped into the Well of the House as soon as it convened in the morning and began shouting slogans and displaying placards. Speaker Om Birla asked MPs to allow the House to function and take up Question Hour. However, as they remained unrelenting, he adjourned the House till 2 p.m.



Stormy session: Rajya Sabha proceedings under way during the Monsoon Session of Parliament in New Delhi on Wednesday. ANI

Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju criticised Opposition MPs for staging skits in the Parliament House complex to protest the alleged theft of donations.

He claimed that the Congress, the Communist parties, and the Samajwadi Party had opposed the construction of the temple and were against Lord Ram.

When the Lok Sabha re-

convened at 2 p.m., the Bankers' Books Evidence Bill was taken up, with Opposition members continuing to raise slogans in the Well of the House. The Bill was taken up for consideration and passed by a voice vote without debate.

"We had given time for discussion, but they [the Opposition] disrupted proceedings," Mr. Rijiju said. Referring to Congress leader K.C. Venugopal as a

"good man", he said Mr. Venugopal should make his party members understand the importance of debate.

He added that the government was open to discussions as decided in meetings of the Business Advisory Committee, but the Opposition should not exert pressure.

Adjournments in RS too
Similar scenes were witnessed in the Rajya Sabha, which saw two adjournments during the first half of the day. A few members managed to deliver their speeches during Zero Hour, which allows MPs to raise issues of national importance. Rajya Sabha Chairman C.P. Radhakrishnan criticised the Opposition for not adhering to the rules of conduct. His repeated appeals to maintain order were ignored by both sides, and the Upper House was adjourned after 26 minutes till noon.

Learn from seniors, stay clear of 'intrigues in Delhi', PM tells new NDA RS MPs

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Wednesday cautioned newly elected Rajya Sabha members of the National Democratic Alliance against falling prey to the "intrigues in Delhi", and urged them to learn from all parliamentarians, including those in the Opposition, during their tenure in the Upper House.

Mr. Modi hosted 37 newly elected Rajya Sabha MPs for breakfast. Among the tips shared by the Prime Minister was a caution about the "web of intrigues" in the Lutyens' Zone of Delhi.

"Be mindful of whom you meet and where you meet. Delhi is a dangerous place," he is reported to have told the MPs. The caution was an echo of a similar warning to NDA MPs during the alliance's Parliamentary Party meet after the 2019 Lok Sabha election. In that speech, Mr. Modi had said that first-



Warm welcome: Prime Minister Narendra Modi meeting the new Rajya Sabha MPs in New Delhi on Wednesday. X/@NARENDRAMODI

time MPs might meet many people eager to serve them, and later these very people could lead to their downfall – the allusion was to not getting caught among middlemen. On Wednesday, the Prime Minister reiterated the advice.

Mr. Modi also instructed the MPs to guard against the misuse of their letterhead and to avoid being rude to people on the phone.

PM's personal routine
Responding to questions about his personal routine,

he told the group that he falls asleep within eight seconds of getting into bed and that he sleeps for only three hours.

He added that it is important to live in the moment to get optimum results. "Right now, I am with you, so I am not thinking about anything else. I think about and live in the moment I am in," he reportedly said.

Those who attended the meeting included BJP president Nitin Nabin, Tarun Chugh, Vinod Tawde, Swati Maliwal, Raghav Chadha, and Ashok Mittal.

Over 43 lakh voters deleted from draft rolls in Jharkhand

Amit Bhelari
PATNA

Almost 16.5% of Jharkhand voters' names have been removed in the draft electoral rolls published by the State Election Commission on Wednesday after the enumeration phase of the on-going special intensive revision (SIR) of voter lists.

Of the 43.6 lakh names that have been removed, over seven lakh are dead, over 14 lakh untraceable, and over 15 lakh have permanently shifted away from the State, Jharkhand Chief Electoral Officer K. Ravi Kumar told presspersons in Ranchi. Another 1.16 lakh voters refused to sign their enumeration forms and did not return them to the booth-level officers (BLOs).

"As many as 43,61,987 voters have been removed, falling under the 'Absent, Shifted, Dead, or Duplicate' (ASDD) categories," Mr. Kumar said.

Second chance

He pointed out that eligible electors whose names existed in the 2026 electoral roll but who failed to submit the enumeration form can still be added back to the rolls during the claims and objections phase from August 5 to September 4. They are required to sub-

1.8 lakh voters excluded from Meghalaya rolls

SHILLONG

Around 1.8 lakh electors have been excluded from draft electoral roll of Meghalaya published on Wednesday after the special intensive revision identified them as deceased, shifted, untraceable or duplicate, officials said. They clarified that the cases will be examined during the claims and objections phase. PTI

mit Form-6 along with the declaration form.

"The Election Commission (EC) is implementing the SIR of the Electoral Rolls in Jharkhand with a clearly defined objective to ensure inclusion of all the eligible citizens of India in the electoral roll and exclusion of all the ineligible electors from the electoral roll with full transparency at every stage of the process," Mr. Kumar said.

"As on July 29, out of 2,64,63,236 electors, 2,21,01,249 (83.51%) electors have submitted their enumeration forms, reflecting an overwhelming participation in the enumeration phase of the SIR," Mr. Kumar said.

The SIR process began in Jharkhand on June 30.

Rahul using children to build political narrative: BJP

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Bharatiya Janata Party on Wednesday accused the Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi of taking a "selective approach" to students' issues by highlighting protests in Delhi while ignoring the ongoing agitation in Congress-ruled Jharkhand.

Responding to Mr. Gandhi's charge that Union Minister Amit Shah was responsible for the violence against young protesters during the march on July 20, BJP MP and spokesperson Sambit Patra accused him of attempting to "build a political narrative through children".

Mr. Patra clarified that his remarks were not directed at the children who accompanied Mr. Gandhi during his press conference, but solely at the Congress leader.

He accused Mr. Gandhi of indulging in the "wrong practice" of "using innocent children as a means to pursue politics". Stating that Prime Minister Narendra Modi and the BJP were with them, Mr. Patra said children need not hesitate to participate in movements or protests whenever necessary.

He also accused Mr. Gandhi of disrupting the functioning of the House.

Rahul steps up attack on Shah; protesters recount police action during march

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, on Wednesday accused Union Home Minister Amit Shah of being responsible for the alleged police excesses recently directed at students protesting against examination paper leaks.

Mr. Gandhi said Mr. Shah lacked the "decency" and "courage" to explain the incident in Parliament.

Addressing the media here, Mr. Gandhi said he had met students from different States, who had participated in the protests. He was proud of the "thousands of students" who had fought for the Constitution, the education system, and the future of the country, he said.

The students had narrated how they were assaulted, beaten and threatened despite protesting peacefully, Mr. Gandhi said. "Complaining about a flawed education system is not a crime. The system needs to be changed and corrected," he said.

Stepping up his attack on the Union Home Minister, Mr. Gandhi said, "There are two possibilities – either he did not know that violence was



Voicing out: Congress leader Rahul Gandhi with a few protesters at a press conference in New Delhi. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

carried out on children, in which case he is incompetent, or he ordered it, which means he is culpable. Either way, he is responsible."

Later, Mr. Gandhi shared photographs from his interaction with students on Instagram, describing the students as "young, fearless, outspoken and patriotic". "And the Prime Minister and Home Minister? Neither the courage to come to Parliament nor the guts to provide answers," he posted.

Protesters speak up

Among those who addressed the media alongside Mr. Gandhi was model Rhiya Ahir, whose photograph blocking a police van during the student protests in Mumbai went viral. Ms. Ahir said she had prevented the unlawful ar-

rest of students and was now facing sustained online harassment. "This is not trolling, it is a crime," she said.

Other students, including Nutan Topo, Farha Naz, Bharat, and Muskan Sharma, also spoke to the media, giving their personal accounts of alleged police brutalities against them at Jantar Mantar.

Ms. Topo alleged that she was hit by pellet firing during the July 20 demonstration. Ms. Naz claimed that police personnel, after finding out her name, labelled her "anti-national". Mr. Bharat alleged he was beaten during the agitation, and said it was important to protest to safeguard democracy.

Mr. Gandhi hailed the students for speaking publicly despite facing harassment.

HC orders removal of deepfake videos targeting Gadkari

Chinmay Gaikwad
MUMBAI

The Bombay High Court directed social media platforms on Wednesday to take down deepfake and AI-generated videos that linked Union Minister Nitin Gadkari to the ethanol blending programme (EBP). The court found the content to be defamatory.

Justice Arif Doctor, presiding over a Single Bench, ordered the removal of all content highlighted by Mr. Gadkari in his lawsuit. The court also issued a directive to remove any similar content in the future if brought to its attention by the Minister.

The order came in response to a suit filed by the Union Minister, who asserted that he had no role in the ethanol blending programme decision-making process. He stated that the policy was managed by the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas.

'False portrayal'

Mr. Gadkari, who has been the Union Minister of Road Transport since 2014, told the court that unknown users had created and circulated videos that falsely portrayed him as responsible for the implementation of the ethanol blending policy. The content also

RS clears Bill to increase number of SC judges

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Rajya Sabha passed the Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Amendment Bill even as the Opposition members walked out before voting on the Bill. The Bill, passed in the Lok Sabha on Monday, is a Money Bill and the Upper House returned it to the Lower House after a discussion.

The Bill increases the number of Supreme Court judges from the present strength of 34 to 38, including the Chief Justice of India. The Bill replaces an Ordinance issued by the government in May. Opposition members questioned the "hurry" for bringing the Ordinance. "Why was this not brought as an Act straight to the Parliament?" asked Congress MP and senior lawyer Vivek Tankha, who initiated the debate.

Replying to the debate, Minister of State for Law and Justice Arjun Ram Meghwal said the increase of judges is a step to improve judicial efficiency.



Nitin Gadkari

made allegations that he and his family had derived undue financial benefits from the programme, implying corruption and misuse of office.

The suit referenced at least 24 posts that contained such allegations. Mr. Gadkari clarified that his legal action was not intended to suppress fair debate or criticism of government policies but to address content that was fabricated and malicious. He also noted that the deepfake content exploited his personality and publicity rights without his consent.

During the proceedings, the court expressed concern over the absence of a mechanism to remove abusive content without judicial intervention. It observed that individuals are compelled to approach courts for relief in such matters.

**इण्डियन ओवरसीज बैंक**
Indian Overseas Bank
अच्छे लोगों को बढ़ावा देना। Good people to grow with.

Information Technology Department
Central Office: 763, Anna Salai, Chennai-600002
Indian Overseas bank (IOB) invites bids for the following:
GOVERNMENT E-MARKET PORTAL - PROCUREMENT OF ENTERPRISE-WIDE EXPECTED CREDIT LOSS (ECL) SOFTWARE SOLUTION
BID NO: GEM/2026/B/7850316 DATED 29.07.2026
The Above GEM Tender document is also available and can be downloaded from the following websites www.iob.bank.in & www.gem.gov.in For Tender details and future amendments, if any, keep referring to the following website www.gem.gov.in

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Information Technology Department
Central Office: 763, Anna Salai, Chennai-600002
Indian Overseas bank (IOB) invites bids for the following:
GOVERNMENT E-MARKET PORTAL - ENGAGEMENT OF CERT-IN EMPANELLED AUDITOR FOR CONDUCTING INFORMATION SYSTEMS AUDIT
BID NO: GEM/2026/B/7853129 DATED 30.07.2026
The Above GEM Tender document is also available and can be downloaded from the following websites www.iob.bank.in & www.gem.gov.in For Tender details and future amendments, if any, keep referring to the following website www.gem.gov.in

**TAMILNADU NEWSPRINT AND PAPERS LIMITED**
(A Govt. of Tamil Nadu Enterprise)
No.67, Anna Salai, Guindy, Chennai - 600 032.

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Tender No	Description	Due Date
262713 003026	Supply of Thermal Rolls made out of TNPL Paper	20.08.2026

Corrigendum if any will be issued in TNPL Website and NIC Portal only. Detailed Terms & Conditions are available in tender document at our websites: www.tnpl.com / www.tntenders.gov.in/nicgep/app

DIPR/2447/TENDER/2026 **TNPL - Maker of bagasse based eco-friendly Paper**

**CENTRE FOR MATERIALS FOR ELECTRONICS TECHNOLOGY (C-MET)**
Panchwati, Off. Dr. Homi Bhabha Road, Pashan, Pune 411 008
Ph: +91-020-25898390/25899273

NOTICE OF INVITATION OF EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI)
This department intends to solicit EOI from interested collaborators for submission of project proposal on Photonic Packaging to MeitY. EOI start **date: 05.08.2026** and last date of submission : **23.08.2026**
Note: For detailed information visit <https://cmet.gov.in>
Sd/-
In-charge Administration

**ODISHA JOINT ENTRANCE EXAMINATION-2026 (OJEE-2026)**

No: OJEE / 387
Date : 05.08.2026

NOTICE FOR NEET UG 2026 QUALIFIED STATE CANDIDATES
Congratulation to all NEET 2026 (UG) qualified candidates of the State.
Admission to MBBS/BDS State Quota seats of different Government and Hi-Tech/ Dreams Medical (Private) Colleges of the State will be done for the session 2026-27 on the basis of NEET 2026 (UG) merit list following rules and regulation of the State Govt.
The online registration and counselling process for state merit list preparation **starts from 06.08.2026**, for other detail schedule, Instructions/Guideline please visit OJEE website. Candidates are advised to keep in touch with website www.ojee.nic.in / www.odishajee.com and OJEE Android/loS App for latest information.
Sd/-
Chairman, OJEE
44001/50/2627
OIPR-44001/44026/1/26-27/0001

DUBAI

Yemen's Houthis say they attacked Saudi tanker off Yanbu in Red Sea



Yemen's Iran-aligned Houthis said on Wednesday they had launched a missile attack on a Saudi oil tanker off the coast of the kingdom's Red Sea port city of Yanbu. The Houthis' military spokesperson, Yahya Saree, did not say when the attack took place. Saudi officials did not respond to a request for comment. REUTERS

ANKARA

Turkish MPs back conditional amnesty for Kurdish militants



A majority of Turkish MPs on Wednesday backed limited and conditional amnesty for PKK Kurdish militants, a first legislative step to end decades of deadly fighting. Entitled "Strengthening National Solidarity and Social Integration," the Bill, which will be put to a vote soon, was signed by 360 of 592 MPs. AFP

CEUTA

Ceuta warns of 'unsustainable' plight for child migrants, seeks aid



The leader of Spain's north African territory of Ceuta on Wednesday said the number of children left there after last week's rush of migrants was "unsustainable", pleading for government aid. Juan Jesus Vivas said that authorities were taking care of 1,100 youngsters against a theoretical capacity of 90. AFP

WASHINGTON

Trump administration revokes visa of Brazil's Ambassador to the U.S.



The United States has revoked the visa of Brazil's Ambassador to the U.S., Maria Luiza Ribeiro Viotti, in retaliation for Brazil's denial of visas for two American diplomats who sought to visit ahead of elections as well as what it said was Brazil's stalling on approving President Donald Trump's nominee to be Ambassador in Brasilia. AP

New Hormuz route agreed, to be managed jointly with Oman: Iran

The geographical coordinates of the route envisaged by the two countries have been agreed upon, and a joint statement, containing the main considerations and points of agreement, is in the final drafting stage, says Tehran's Foreign Ministry

Agence France-Presse
TEHRAN

Iran and Oman have agreed to a route for ships transiting the Strait of Hormuz and are putting the final touches on arrangements for jointly managing the passage, Tehran's Foreign Ministry said on Wednesday.

Iran has seized *de facto* control of the strait, a strategic waterway for the global energy trade, since the U.S. and Israel launched their war against the country on February 28.

U.S. President Donald Trump has repeatedly insisted Tehran is keen to do a deal to reopen the route



Motorists drive past a large billboard pledging revenge against Donald Trump along Jomhouri Street in central Tehran. AFP

to shipping, but Iran denies this and says it will instead make arrangements with its neighbour across the strait, Oman.

"The geographical coor-

dinates of the route envisaged by the two sides have been agreed upon and, if certain third parties do not obstruct the process, the joint statement of the two

countries, containing the main considerations and points of agreement, is also in the final review and drafting stage," spokesperson Esmail Baqaei said, according to state news agency IRNA.

According to the report, Mr. Baqaei told presspersons that talks with Oman were moving forward, but that even if an understanding was reached, it would not mean that the strait had become safe for all passing vessels.

"The factors making the Strait of Hormuz insecure still exist on the part of the United States, particularly the naval blockade and other aggressive and threa-

tening actions against Iran and its interests," he said.

Mr. Trump had said Tuesday a deal with Iran to reopen Hormuz could happen "tomorrow or the next day," telling reporters in California that negotiators "had a very good day".

"The strait is going to be open very soon, or they're going to get hit very hard – and then the strait's going to be open," Mr. Trump said in an interview with Fox News.

Secretary of State Marco Rubio said Tuesday that the United States was involved in negotiations between Oman and Iran on increasing traffic through the Strait of Hormuz.

Russian barrage on Kyiv kills 17; defences fall short

Associated Press
KYIV

Russian attacks on Kyiv and its surrounding region killed 17 people and wounded dozens, President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said on Wednesday, as Ukraine's depleted air defences failed to stop any of Moscow's incoming missiles overnight.

The barrage, which lasted about two hours, was the latest in a series of large-scale Russian missile strikes that have become almost routine this summer. Moscow is exploiting Ukraine's critical shortage of interceptors for the U.S.-made Patriot systems, the sole air defence weapon in its arsenal able to shoot down ballistic missiles.

Mr. Zelenskyy has pleaded with other coun-



Railway workers gather on railway tracks next to bodies in plastic bags of people killed during Russian strikes on Wednesday. AFP

tries, especially the United States, to send more of the ammunition made scarcer by the Iran war. Failing that, he wants to make Patriot ammunition in Ukraine.

Mr. Zelenskyy said after a Russian aerial attack on Friday night that air defences shot down only one ballistic missile "solely be-

cause there are no missiles for the Patriots".

The targets hit in the barrage included a brewery, a warehouse for construction material, and a mail sorting office that had nothing to do with the war, Mr. Zelenskyy said. But Russia's Defence Ministry said the businesses had military ties.

Dhaka turns Hasina's official residence into memorial museum

Press Trust of India
DHAKA



Sheikh Hasina

Amid tightened nationwide security, Bangladesh on Wednesday inaugurated a memorial museum at the official residence of ousted Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina to commemorate the victims of violence during the anti-government protests in 2024 that toppled her government.

Prime Minister Tarique Rahman inaugurated the 'July Mass Uprising Memorial Museum' at Ganabhaban, Prime Minister's official residence during Ms. Hasina's regime, coinciding with the day she left to India on August 5, 2024.

Mr. Rahman announced that government institutions would be named after slain activists of the uprising and those who were killed during the rule of Ms. Hasina's Awami League since 2009.

According to a UN report, up to 1,400 people were killed between July 15 and August 15 last year.

China announces countermeasures against Washington

Associated Press
BANGKOK

China announced a series of economic measures on Wednesday against the United States, including controls on exports of drones to the U.S. and a ban on dealings with six American entities, in response to recent restrictions imposed by Washington.

Tensions are simmering between the world's two biggest economies ahead of an expected visit by Chinese President Xi Jinping to the U.S. in September, despite signs of warming ties during his meetings with U.S. President Donald Trump in Beijing in May.

The Commerce Ministry

said the sanctions are in response to recent moves from the U.S., including a ban by the U.S. Federal Communications Commission on imports of Chinese drones, and the Department of Homeland Security's decision to add 43 Chinese companies to the Uyghur Forced Labour Prevention Act entity list to prevent imports of goods made with forced labour.

The "measures seriously violate the important consensus reached by the two heads of state and severely damage China's legitimate rights and interests. China has no choice but to take necessary countermeasures in response," the Ministry said.

Abdul El-Sayed wins Michigan Senate primary in major win for progressives

Associated Press
DETROIT



Massive support: Abdul El-Sayed speaks during a news conference at the Spirit of Detroit, in Michigan, on Wednesday. AP

Abdul El-Sayed has won Michigan's Democratic nomination for U.S. Senate, defeating U.S. Representative Haley Stevens in a massive victory for the party's progressive wing in a battleground state.

The real test of Mr. El-Sayed's and progressives' strength will now come in a November match-up against Republican Mike Rogers, a former congressman who ran unopposed for the GOP nomination. The seat is pivotal to Democrats' chances of flipping the Senate and Mr. El-Sayed will face the challenge of uniting a divided Democratic base after a

bruising primary.

The race remained tight throughout Tuesday night, with a winner not declared until early Wednesday. In his final remarks at a primary night party before the race was called, Mr. El-Sayed said, "tomorrow we begin to mend fences".

Mr. El-Sayed's win represents a significant shift for the Democratic Party; in 2018, he lost the gubernatorial primary to now-Governor Gretchen Whitmer by 21 percentage points.

Mr. El-Sayed, a former health official, campaigned

on "Medicare for All," halting military aid to Israel and campaign finance reform. He had support from progressive leaders including Senator Bernie Sanders and U.S. Representative Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez, who framed the race as a grassroots-focused movement and a broader fight against the establishment and big-money spending.

Now comes the more difficult challenge for Democrats: uniting the party to defeat Mr. Rogers, for whom Republicans have already reserved large sums of money ahead of the general election. Democrats consider the seat a must-win if they are to flip control of the Senate this year.

कार्यालय नगर निगम जयपुर
पण्डित दीनदयाल उपाध्याय भवन, लालकोठी, जयपुर
दिनांक : 03.08.2026
क्रमांक :- जसअ / 2026 / 199
अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा सूचना क्रमांक :- 13-14 / 2026-27
नगर निगम जयपुर हेतु सीवर जेटिंग मशीन तथा सुपर सकर मशीन क्रय किये जाने हेतु
पंजीकृत फर्मस से ई-निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा प्रपत्र, विस्तृत सूचना एवं शर्तें
आदि सम्पूर्ण विवरण वेबसाइट www.jaypurm.org, www.sppp.raj.nic.in and
www.eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in पर स्टेट पब्लिक प्रोक्यूरमेंट के UBN No.
JMC2627GLOB00309 to JMC2627GLOB00310 पर देखी जा सकती है।
राज.संवाद / 26 / 8758
अधीक्षण अभियन्ता (जैराज)

National Centre for Radio Astrophysics
TATA INSTITUTE OF FUNDAMENTAL RESEARCH
Post Bag No. 3, Ganeshkhind, Pune 411007
Email: estt@ncra.tifr.res.in; URL: <http://www.ncra.tifr.res.in>
Recruitment Advt. No. 2026/10
1. Project Engineer (Electronics) [1-Post; 1-UR; HQ: RAC, Ooty]
2. Engineer Trainee (Electronics) [2 Posts, UR; HQ: RAC, Ooty]
3. Lab Assistant Trainee (Electronics) [1 Post, UR; HQ: RAC, Ooty]
Last Date is **31-Aug-2026**. For detailed advertisement and for making online application, Visit <https://tinyurl.com/ncrajob-2026>

TAMILNADU INDUSTRIAL DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION LIMITED
19-A, Rukmini Lakshmiipathi Road, Egmore, Chennai - 600 008
CIN:U65983TN1965SGC005327
e-TENDER NOTICE
NIT. No. TIDCO/FINTECH TOWER/2026-1 Date:06.08.2026
TIDCO invites bids from the eligible bidders through e-Tender for the work mentioned below:

Name of the Work	Approx Value of work in Rs.	EMD Amount in Rs.
e-Tender for Laying of Granolithic Flooring at Fintech Tower, Fintech City, Nandambakkam Village, Alandur Taluk, Chennai District.	1.82 Cr	1,10,300/-

Tenders shall be uploaded through <https://tntenders.gov.in> on or before **3.00 PM on 21.08.2026** and the same will be opened on **21.08.2026 at 4.00 PM**.
For More details please visit <https://tntenders.gov.in>
CHAIRMAN AND MANAGING DIRECTOR
DIPR/2448/Tender/2026
TIDCO

CHITTARANJAN LOCOMOTIVE WORKS
NOTICE FOR ENGAGEMENT OF CONTRACT
MEDICAL PRACTITIONERS
No. GMA/GS/1521(CMP)(4)-Pt-III, Date:03.08.2026. Chittaranjan Locomotive Works (CLW), under the Ministry of Railways, Government of India desires to engage Contract Medical Practitioners (Specialist) on full time contract basis on fixed monthly remuneration against 02 (UR-02) vacant post through Walk-in-Interview for a period of one (01) year or till further order whichever is earlier. Notification in this regard has been uploaded in CLW Website (<https://clw.indianrailways.gov.in>) → under link News & Recruitment → Recruitment, Eligible Doctors (Specialist) are advised to fill up the application format enclosed as Annexure-A with the Notification dated 31.07.2026 and report to KG Hospital/Chittaranjan for Walk-in-Interview on **25.08.2026 (10:00 AM)**.
PR 5/453 SPO/Gaz./CLW/Chittaranjan
visit us on: www.facebook.com/clwrailways

झारखंड सरकार
कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, गोड्डा 814133
(rdsd.godda@gmail.com)
शुद्धि पत्र
इस कार्यालय द्वारा आहूत ई निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या RWD/SD/GODDA/06/2026-27 जिसका पी.आर. संख्या 385257 Rural Development (26-27)D है के Instruction To Bidders (ITB) के तहत पृष्ठ संख्या 11 के कंडिका 4.4A.b में Satisfactorily completed, as a prime Contractor at least 19.38 M Length of single bridge work (minimum 50% of the bridge length of tender invited). के स्थान पर Satisfactorily completed, as a prime Contractor at least 38.74 M Length of single bridge work (minimum 50% of the bridge length of tender invited) पढ़ा जाय। अन्य सभी शर्तें यथावत रहेगा।
कार्यपालक अभियंता
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल,
PR 386696 Rural Development (26-27)_D **गोड्डा**

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, चतरा
ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना
डी0एम0एफ0टी0 मंद से चतरा जिलान्तर्गत स्वीकृत निम्नांकित योजनाओं के क्रियान्वयन हेतु ग्रामीण विकास विभाग (ग्रामीण कार्य मामले), झारखण्ड सरकार द्वारा समुचित श्रेणी के निबंधित संवेदकों से एकल लिफाफा / डि (Two) लिफाफा पद्धति के अंतर्गत निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है।
ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या :-RDD/SD/CHATRA/15/2026-27/RE_01
1. कार्य की विस्तृत विवरणी :-

यु.पं सं०	प्रखण्ड	पंचायत	ग्राम	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि	अग्रधन की राशि	परिमाण विपत्र का मूल्य	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि	लिफाफा पद्धति
1	Simariya	Hurnali	Tapsa	Construction of High Level Girder Bridge Across Bhurahi River no Hurmur to Tapsa in Gram Tapsa Under Hurnali Panchayat	23636286	472800	10000	18 माह	द्वि (Two)
2	Simariya	Chope	Torar	Construction of High Level Girder Bridge Across Local Nala at Gram Torar Under Chope Panchayat	32399953	648000	10000	18 माह	द्वि (Two)

2. वेबसाइट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि—10.08.2026

3. ई-निविदा प्राप्ति की तिथि एवं समय—दिनांक—10.08.2026 से दिनांक—20.08.2026 के अपराह्न 05:00 बजे तक

4. ई-निविदा खोलने का स्थान—कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, चतरा।

5. ई-निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय—22.08.2026 अपराह्न 02:00 बजे

6. ई-निविदा आमंत्रित करनेवाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता :—कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, चतरा।

7. ई-निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का दूरभाष सं०—9431060939 (संबंधित कार्यपालक अभियंता का दूरभाष नम्बर)

8. परिमाण विपत्र की राशि घट-बढ़ सकती है, तदनुसार अग्रधन की राशि देय होगी।

9. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रधन की राशि का ई-भुगतान जिस खाता से किया जायेगा, उसी खाते में अग्रधन की राशि वापस होगी। अगर खाता को बन्द कर दिया जाता है तो उसकी सारी जवाबदेही आपकी होगी।

10. निविदा जानकारी के लिये वेबसाइट www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in एवं कार्यालय की सूचना पट्ट पर देखा जा सकता है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता,
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल,
चतरा
PR 386671 (Rural Development)26-27*D

INBRIEF



Arsenal agrees to £75 million Guimaraes deal: reports

Arsenal has reportedly agreed a £75 million fee with Newcastle to sign captain Bruno Guimaraes. The Brazil midfielder's future has been the subject of fevered speculation for weeks since it emerged he wanted to leave Tyneside for the Emirates Stadium.



Salah arrives in Istanbul ahead of Trabzonspor move

Mohamed Salah was greeted by cheering Trabzonspor fans in Istanbul on Wednesday as he closed in on a move to the Turkish club. The Liverpool icon wore the team's blue and burgundy striped shirt after flying in on a private jet to complete the deal. "Trabzon are you ready? I can hear you. See you very soon," Salah said in a video message posted on the club's X profile.

National junior u-18 clay court tennis from August 8

The 33rd edition of the MCC-N. Sankar Memorial National junior u-18 clay court tennis championship will be held from August 8 to 15 at the Madras Cricket Club (MCC) courts in Chennai. The tournament is organised by MCC in association with the Tamil Nadu Tennis Association under the aegis of the All India Tennis Association. The qualifying rounds will begin on August 8, while the main draw starts on August 10. The doubles finals are scheduled for August 14, followed by the singles finals on August 15. The top 120 boys and 104 girls from across the country will feature in the singles and doubles events.

LIVE TELECAST

Durand Cup: Sony Sports Ten 2 & LIV, 4 & 7 p.m.
TNPL: Sony Sports Ten 4 Tamil & TNPL Official Youtube channel (youtube@tamilnadupremierleague), 7.30 p.m.

Indian Army eases past Baghpat, on top of Group B



First strike: Samir opened the scoring for Indian Army in the 11th minute. X@THEDURANDCUP

DURAND CUP

Sports Bureau
KOLKATA

Indian Army stormed to the top of Group B with a dominant 4-0 victory over Baghpat FC in a group league match of the 135th Durand Cup tournament at the Kishore Bharati Stadium on Wednesday. The Army side produced a fine first-half performance, with Samir Murmu, Saikhom Borish Singh, Shubham Rana, and Christopher Kamei finding the net in succession to seal

their team's second successive win. The win also took Indian Army to six points from two matches and moved it ahead of Samaleswari FC – also on six points – on the basis of a superior goal difference. Baghpat, which suffered its third consecutive defeat, exited the tournament without a point. In the other match of the day, Indian Navy FT beat NEROCA FC 2-0 in a Group D encounter at the Khuman Lampak Main Stadium in Imphal. Roshan Panna opened the scoring in the first half before E. Muhammed In-

ayath doubled the lead after the break to seal the Sailors' first win. Indian Navy had lost its opening fixture 0-1 to local side FC Raengdai. The win lifted Indian Navy to three points from two matches, leaving it second in the group behind FC Raengdai (six points). **The results: Group B: (Kolkata):** Indian Army FT 4 (Samir Murmu 11, Saikhom Borish Singh 22, Shubham Rana 35, Christopher Kamei 45+3) bt Baghpat FC 0. **Group D (Imphal):** Indian Navy FT 2 (Roshan Panna 23, Muhammed Inayath 65) bt NEROCA FC 0.

A calculated risk which paid off for Sakshi at the CWG

Y.B. Sarangi
KOLKATA

A calculated risk to drop from 54kg to 51kg paid off for newly-crowned Commonwealth Games champion Sakshi Chaudhary. A former World junior champion, two-time World youth champion, Asian championships bronze medallist and World Boxing Cup gold medallist, Sakshi secured most of her international medals in 54kg. Hungry for success at a multi-sport event, the gutsy Sakshi sought the advice of her coach Chhote Lal Yadav at the Army Sports Institute (ASI) in Pune, and decided to switch to 51kg after the National championships in January, when boxers were allowed to change weight categories. For Sakshi, it was a risky decision as the lower weight class had several accomplished boxers, including double World champion Nikhat Zareen and reigning World champion Meenakshi Hooda. "Since (another Army boxer) Preeti (Pawar) was doing well in the 54kg, it made sense for Sakshi to come down to 51kg. She was capable of beating eve-

ryone. Once we made the make-or-break decision, I asked her to keep quiet as it could have backfired," Chhote Lal told *The Hindu*, as his ward stayed busy attending felicitation functions. "Only a few boxers have qualities like Sakshi. She is aggressive, has good endurance and has a superb left jab, which she used effectively in Glasgow. Even during her training at the ASI, she used to beat male boxers because of the jab. I am sure she will medal at the Asian Games as well." Former Indian women's team head coach Bhaskar Bhatt, under whom Sakshi claimed her maiden World youth gold in Guwahati in 2017, said, "Sakshi didn't stop for a moment during her bouts at the Commonwealth Games and didn't give her opponents any chance. It shows how much work she has put in to increase her endurance and strengthen her legs. "She should work on two areas to become even more effective. She needs to connect her punches with the full knuckle to unleash maximum power and stop using her elbow to stay away from trouble," said Bhatt.

No practice games for Australia before India Tests: McDonald

Press Trust of India
MELBOURNE

Australia head coach Andrew McDonald has revealed that his team will not play any practice match before its high-profile Border-Gavaskar Trophy away Test series against India next year, as a short preparatory camp in conditions similar to the sub-continent would be more useful. The much-anticipated five-Test series is scheduled to start on January 21 in Nagpur. "We feel as though we've got enough time to immerse ourselves in those conditions. We won't be taking on a practice game. It'll just be more around the loca-

tion," McDonald told *cricket.com.au*. "We've got a couple of options there. We have gone to the UAE previously and we have also gone into India last time into Bengaluru. "So we're just working through what that would look like in terms of how we then manage the individuals."

TAMIL NADU ROUND-UP

Tiruvallur beats Chengalpattu
TENKASI: Tiruvallur eased to a four-wicket win over Chengalpattu in a Group-G fixture of the TNCA inter-district under-14 tournament on Wednesday. **The scores: Group-G: At Tenkasi:** Chengalpattu 121 in 45.4 overs (Hari Sainath 38, N. Haethish 3/15, Dhashwanth Siddhan 3/23) lost to Tiruvallur 122/6 in 46.1 overs (R.V. Bhuvanendra 33, S. Jishnu 31). **Group-H: At Kancheepuram:** Kancheepuram vs. Karur: Match abandoned without a ball being bowled due to a wet outfield. Two points shared. **Raghav takes the honours**
CHENNAI: FIDE Master Raghav of Velammal Vidyalaya (Karambakkam)



Raghav. claimed the title in 15th Modern School International FIDE-rating chess championship and also won ₹25,000 in prize money. Venkata Naga Karthik of Lake Montfort School (Bengaluru) finished runner-up and received

₹20,000, while Sundar Guhan of Chinmaya Vidyalaya (Chennai) secured third place and earned ₹15,000. The tournament, organised by Modern Senior Secondary School under the aegis of the Tamil Nadu State Chess Association (TNSCA) and the All India Chess Federation (AICF), attracted 515 players, including 159 FIDE-rated participants, from across India and overseas. **ENGAGEMENTS** **General:** SRMIST Founder's Birthday Trophy inter-collegiate invitation tournament: Ball badminton and kabaddi, SRM College of Agricultural Sciences, Achara-pakkam, 7.45 a.m.

Saravanan and Gurjapneet help Madurai Panthers pull off a heist

The two emerge unlikely batting heroes to guide the team past Grand Cholas; Royal Kings ease to victory against Super Gillies

TNPL

S. Shrivathsan
DINDIGUL

The phrase 'it's not over until it's over' holds true for sport, especially the shortest format of cricket where the complexion of a match can change in the blink of an eye. The unpredictable nature of T20s was on full display at the Tamil Nadu Premier League on Wednesday, when Madurai Panthers snatched victory from the jaws of defeat against Trichy Grand Cholas. At the NPR College Ground here, P. Saravanan (26 not out off 13 balls, 2x4, 2x6) and Gur-



Winning partnership: Gurjapneet and Saravanan turned things around for the Panthers in quick time. G. KARTHIKEYAN

japneet Singh (21 not out off nine balls, 3x4, 1x6) emerged as the unlikely batting heroes, pulling off

a nail-biting two-wicket win with two deliveries to spare. When Gurjapneet

joined forces with Saravanan, Panthers appeared to be down in the dumps – they required 42 runs off

just 17 balls in their 174-run pursuit. But Gurjapneet provided a glimmer of hope, smacking Antony Dhas for two fours and a six in the 18th over, before Saravanan completed the epic turnaround with a maximum and a four off R. Rajkumar in the final over. The Panthers enjoyed a slice of luck in the penultimate over, during which Shyam Sundar spilled a chance offered by Saravanan at long-off. **Rajalingam shines** Earlier, pacer S. Rajalingam (three for 26) helped Madurai keep Trichy down to 173 for seven after B. Anirudh Sitaram elected to field. In the other game, a final flourish with the bat

and a well-executed bowling show propelled Nellai Royal Kings to a comfortable 50-run victory over Chepauk Super Gillies. **The scores:** Trichy Grand Cholas 173/7 in 20 overs (J. Suresh Kumar 43, Sanjay Yadav 37 n.o., R. Rajkumar 35, S. Rajalingam 3/26) lost to Madurai Panthers 174/8 in 19.4 overs (Kiran Karthikeyan 38, Gowtham Thamarai Kannan (Impact Player) 2/36, R. Rajkumar 2/37, Antony Dhas 3/36). Nellai Royal Kings 204/6 in 20 overs (S.R. Athish 41, Ritthik Easwaran 36, Sonu Yadav 35 n.o., Abhishek Tanwar 2/54, M. Silambarasan 2/24) bt Chepauk Super Gillies 154 in 17.2 overs (Ashwanth Valthapa 31, R. Rohit 2/41, B. Rocky (IP) 2/22, N.S. Harish 4/25, Sonu Yadav 2/16). **Thursday's match:** SKM Salem Spartans vs. Vida Kovai Kings, 7.30 p.m.

In Ashwin-Varun absence, Nirankar rises



Miserly spell: Nirankar, who moved from MP to TN to fuel his dream, tightened the screws in the middle overs. G. KARTHIKEYAN

S. Shrivathsan
DINDIGUL

When Dindigul Dragons strolled out for the Tamil Nadu Premier League season-opener here on Tuesday, there was uncertainty over how the 2024 title-winner would cope with the absence of two masters of the spin-bowling craft. R. Ashwin is in the dugout as a mentor and not on the field while Varun Chakravarthy is yet to recover from a hamstring injury. But in an encouraging sign for its adaptive strategy, the Dindigul side watched debutant leggie Nirankar Sharma dish out a Player-of-the-Match performance of three for 21 against iDream Tiruppur Tamizhans. Nirankar, who moved from Madhya Pradesh to Tamil Nadu to fuel his cricket dream, tightened the screws in the middle overs with his miserly spell.

"I was just so excited. It was an emotional moment for me because I had waited for it (making his maiden appearance at such a level) for years. I could not have asked for a better debut. The Dragons management, Ashwin *bhaiya* and Inder (B. Indrajith) *anna* have been supporting me a lot," said Nirankar, the lone DD spinner in action on Tuesday. **Enjoying his time** The 26-year-old is enjoying the time of his professional life while learning the tricks of the trade from Ashwin. "I had dreamt of working with him. He has been superb with his mentorship. He is expecting a lot from me. Hopefully, I fulfil his expectations. I cannot ask for anything better with what is going on in my life," he added. After making a good first impression, Nirankar should strive for consistency.

Pragg leads after rapid phase



Anish and Praggnanadhaa face off. FLICKR/GRANDCHESSTOUR

CHESS

Press Trust of India
ST. LOUIS

Grandmaster R. Praggnanandhaa topped the rapid section of the St. Louis Rapid and Blitz, scoring 12 points out of a possible 18 to keep his hopes alive for a place in the Grand Chess Tour (GCT) finals. Praggnanandhaa lost the ninth and final round in the rapid section to GM Jorden van Foreest but still

managed to retain a one-point lead, finishing ahead of Javokhir Sindarov. There are 18 more blitz games to be played before the winner is determined for the \$200,000 prize pool out of which \$50,000 goes to the champion. **Standings after rapid:** 1. R. Praggnanandhaa (12); 2. Javokhir Sindarov (11); 3. Wesley So (11); 4-7: Levon Aronian, Lennier Dominguez Perez, Anish Giri, Vincent Keymer 9 each; 8-9: Fabiano Caruana, Jorden Van Foreest 8 each; 10. Awonder Leong (5).

Tale of the tape – a study in extremes and an unsettled championship

Five different winners in five races, a title fight that keeps rewriting itself every fortnight. It hasn't all been smooth sailing under the new rules. If this is what growing pains look like, Formula 1's new era is at least proving it can keep everyone guessing



All to drive for: Antonelli, Russell and Hamilton are in a battle for the top prize. AP, REUTERS

R.K. Arjun

Halfway through 2026, Formula 1 has delivered everything except a settled championship. A rookie in a Mercedes built a 66-point lead, then watched it evaporate to 25 in less than a month. A four-time champion resurrected the Red Bull while many were questioning whether he would continue in Formula one. A team that hadn't won all season suddenly looked unbeatable in Budapest. Five different winners in five races and a title fight that keeps rewriting itself every fortnight. It hasn't all been smooth sailing under the new rules. Moments like Silverstone's software blunder and driver complaints about battery-dependent racing are hard to romanticise. However, if this is what growing pains look like, Formula 1's new era is at least proving it can keep everyone guessing.

George Russell converted pole into victory in the season opener at Albert Park, fending off an early Charles Leclerc charge before a Virtual Safety Car handed Mercedes the decisive strategic edge. Kimi Antonelli recovered from a poor start to complete a Mercedes 1-2, with Leclerc salvaging third after Ferrari's one-stop gamble backfired late on. Lewis Hamilton finished fourth, just six-tenths behind his teammate. While Max Verstappen produced the drive of the day, recovering from 20th on the grid to 6th.

Shanghai belonged to F1's newest wonderkid. After Russell claimed Saturday's Sprint, his Mercedes teammate stole the spotlight in the Grand Prix, converting pole into a maiden F1 win at just 19 years old – becoming the youngest polesitter in the sport's history in the process. Hamilton surged into an early race lead but couldn't hold off Antonelli's recovery, eventually settling for a maiden Ferrari podium in third as Russell completed a second consecutive Mercedes 1-2. It was a weekend to forget for reigning title holders, with both McLaren cars failing to make the start after electrical issues on the grid.

History was made once again at Suzuka. Antonelli claimed his second consecutive win, recovering from a wheelspin-hit start that dropped him to sixth before an Ollie Bearman crash triggered a mid-race Safety Car which swung the race back in his favour. The result meant that he became the first teenager to win back-to-back races. Oscar Piastri secured McLaren's first podium of

the season in second, with Leclerc completing the podium after edging out his teammate in a tense intra-Ferrari fight. Russell, starting from second, could only manage fourth. Antonelli carried a nine-point lead over Russell into F1's first month-long break, the youngest championship leader in the sport's history after consecutive wins in China and Japan.

As the season resumed in Miami, the Italian made it three wins in a row, holding off a race-long challenge from Lando Norris. Pole-sitter Antonelli locked up alongside Verstappen and Leclerc into Turn 1, with the Red Bull spinning out shortly after and triggering an early Safety Car following separate crashes for Isack Hadjar and Pierre Gasly. The lead changed hands repeatedly through the race, with Norris and Piastri both enjoying spells at the front before Antonelli reasserted control. Piastri completed the podium in third, while Leclerc's afternoon ended in the wall, completing the story of a disappointing return for Ferrari after the break.

Canada brought heartbreak for one Mercedes driver and history for the other. Russell led from pole and looked set for victory in Montreal, only for a late power unit failure to hand Antonelli his fourth win in a row. Hamilton profited from the chaos to claim his best Ferrari finish yet in second, while Verstappen finally found his first podium of the season in third. This result stretched Antonelli's lead at the top to 43 points. Monaco descended into chaos, and the Mercedes wonderkid simply drove away from it with a dominant lights-to-flag victory after Verstappen's front-row start ended in a stall and immediate retirement. Leclerc's podium bid crashed out late on a crumbling track surface, while his Ferrari teammate secured back-to-back second-place finishes. Once again, the day's biggest fallout fell to Russell, who was hit with a pit-lane speeding penalty en route to a forgettable finish outside the points. Antonelli's championship lead stood at a staggering 66 points as he secured his fifth win in six rounds.

Hamilton finally ended his Ferrari drought in style at the newly-hosted Barcelona-Catalunya Grand Prix, converting an aggressive undercut strategy and a well-timed Virtual Safety Car stop into his first win for the Scuderia, 686 days after his last victory. Russell and Norris completed a historic all-British podium. Championship leader Antonelli's

dominant start finally hit a snag, retiring just four laps from the finish after briefly passing his teammate. The result cut Antonelli's lead to 50 points, ending Mercedes' perfect run to open the season.

Mercedes reclaimed track dominance, as Russell secured his second win of the season at the Red Bull Ring. Antonelli endured a rough afternoon, running wide twice in the opening laps and admitting he'd gotten "too excited," while Max Verstappen produced a strong recovery from fifth to finish second after his own qualifying crash. Russell's win cut Antonelli's championship lead to 40 points, though the Mercedes rookie's third place was enough to protect his advantage. Ferrari, meanwhile, endured a quiet weekend, with both cars finishing outside the top four.

Leclerc ended a winless run stretching back to Austin 2024 in the most chaotic way imaginable, crossing the line first at Silverstone after Antonelli's late mechanical failure handed him control of the race. But the headlines belonged just as much to the finish itself: a "Safety Car In This Lap" message was shown in error before being withdrawn, and the race ended fully behind the safety car for the first time since Monza 2022. Russell claimed second after a bold tyre gamble paid off, Hamilton completed the podium, and the championship leader was classified a distant 16th after a penalty compounded his misfortune.

The Italian driver bounced back from a difficult month with a commanding win at Spa, losing the lead twice. First to Verstappen off the line through Eau Rouge, then to a Ferrari strategy masterstroke during a Virtual Safety Car sequence. The Italian teenager reclaimed the lead on the Kemmel Straight with six laps to go. Leclerc held on for second despite never getting back into range, with Verstappen completing the podium. The result was overshadowed early on by Russell's opening-lap retirement, colliding with Hamilton at Turn 6 as his race ended in the gravel, while Hamilton was handed a five-second penalty for his part in the incident. Norris salvaged some points, finishing seventh from 13th on the grid after a gamble on Safety Car timing didn't pay off, though he did set the race's fastest lap on the final tour. The win stretched Antonelli's championship lead to 45 points. McLaren finally had their day, but it came with a side of internal drama. Oscar Piastri seized the lead from teammate Lando Norris at Turn 1 and

controlled the race for its first half, until he was hit by a lapped Carlos Sainz. The delay in getting past the Williams was enough for Norris to overcut his teammate at the second stop. The Australian's afternoon went from bad to worse as he not only lost time in traffic but a late gearbox on Lap 56 forced a retirement. The resulting Virtual Safety Car proved a lifeline for Antonelli, who used it to recover from a seventh-place grid slot to a damage-limiting third. Verstappen secured second through an extended tyre strategy. Hamilton crossed the line fourth only to be demoted to fifth by a late pit-lane speeding penalty, his fourth infraction in three race weekends/

Formula 1's 2026 season has been a study in extremes. It began with a bang in Melbourne under a radically overhauled rulebook: no DRS, new power units, a fresh chassis philosophy, and quickly found its star: Kimi Antonelli. The 19-year-old won five of the first six races of the season, becoming the youngest points leader in the sport's history and building a 66-point championship lead by Monaco. Then the season turned. A retirement in Barcelona let Hamilton end a 686-day victory drought in stunning fashion for his first win in red. A mistake-strewn Austria let Russell back into the fight. Silverstone's chaotic, software-error-marred finish handed Leclerc his first win in nearly two years while gutting Antonelli's result entirely. By the time the sport reached Spa, Antonelli's once-commanding lead had been cut to just 25 points.

Spa and Hungary, though, showed exactly why he still leads. A composed recovery drive in Belgium and a damage-limiting third place in Budapest, despite starting from a penalised seventh, which stretched his advantage back out to 50 points heading into the summer break, even as Norris finally delivered McLaren's first win of the season.

Now, after a month-long break, the sport will resume at Zandvoort for the final Dutch Grand Prix under the current promoter agreement.

Verstappen's home race arrives at a pivotal moment for Red Bull, who are still searching for their first win of the season. Beyond that, Monza, a maiden Madrid GP, and Singapore's Sprint finale await before the season turns toward its final leg. With Antonelli's lead sizeable but not unassailable, and Ferrari and McLaren both building momentum, the second half promises to be as exciting as the first.

THE GIST

The 2026 season began with a bang in Melbourne under a radically overhauled rulebook: no DRS, new power units, a fresh chassis philosophy

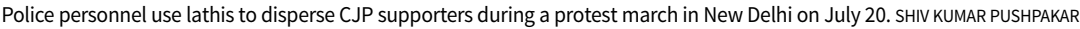
Antonelli won five of the first six races of the season, becoming the youngest points leader in the sport's history and building a 66-point championship lead by Monaco

With Antonelli's lead sizeable but not unassailable, and Ferrari and McLaren both building momentum, the second half promises to be just as combustible as the first



Nivedita S.
CHENNAI

Another compound the Tear Smoke

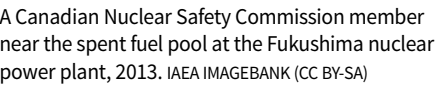


According to the Kerala Police Manual of 1970, personnel must use the lathi only

Kinetic impact projectiles are plastic or rubber bullets with metal fragments, and include those fired by pellet guns. However, these projectiles are inaccurate, particularly at long distances, and can cause indiscriminate harm. Around five protesters at the CJP march reportedly suffered pellet gun injuries, with one risking loss of vision.

In India, information on the crowd control devices that security personnel possess and use is not easily available. Regular audits are necessary to ensure these devices meet quality standards and tests should be conducted in a manner that reveals the weapons' full impact before they are deployed, per the UN guidance. Also according to the guidance, the state must monitor the use of force and information about the crowd must be disaggregated to the extent possible on the basis of age, gender, and disabilities before deciding which devices to use. It also requires any serious injuries or deaths caused by such devices to be duly investigated by the competent authority.

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'Ghost particles' can point way to spent nuclear fuel

Vasudevan Mukunth

A new study in *Physical Review Letters* by researchers of the 'Double Chooz' Collaboration in France has reported a breakthrough in this domain. The team has reported the first measurement of the signature of particles emitted by spent nuclear fuel, which a detector can detect even from a distance.

For decades, cameras and close inspections were used to ensure operators were not diverting spent nuclear fuel for illicit uses

The ability to measure the residual flux allows monitors to remotely verify the spent fuel inventory. If a rogue state clandestinely removes fuel assemblies from a cooling pool to extract plutonium – a key ingredient of nuclear weapons – the neutrino glow from that pool would diminish.

Future detectors

In a 2019 study in *Nature Communications*, researchers in the U.S. also reasoned that compact and portable detectors of the future could help authorities discover small, undeclared facilities used to produce fissile materials. However, building such machines is still a significant challenge. Current detectors are large and stationary because they need to filter out cosmic rays, which are constantly streaming in from space.

Strange stars: a quiz on the universe's more unusual twinklers

Vasudevan Mukunth

QUESTION 1

The collective name of these neutron stars comes from their most outstanding feature — magnetic fields a quadrillion-times stronger than that of the earth. This is why they can scramble a credit card from 1,000 km away and polarise light passing close to them. What are these stars called?

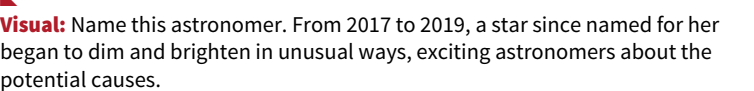
QUESTION 2

A neutron star forms when a massive star collapses, squeezing its electrons and protons into neutrons. Scientists think that the neutrons could further collapse to form a ____ star. Fill in the blank with a type of whimsically named subatomic particle that, together with gluons, makes up protons and neutrons.

QUESTION 3

QUESTION 5

Sometimes, a star can survive its supernova explosion without being destroyed — but in exchange for being thrown across its galaxy at a very high speed. For instance, SGR 0501+4516 is flying through the Milky Way at 1.7 lakh km/hr. What is the colloquial name for these stars?



Answers to August 4 quiz:

1. Monk who contributed to making better sparkling wine – **Ans: Dom Perignon**
 2. Fibres that contributes to bubbling in champagne – **Ans: Cellulose**
 3. Process whereby vapour cools and clumps together – **Ans: Condensation**
 4. Pigments in skins of grapes that give red wine its colour – **Ans: Anthocyanins**
 5. Sweet-smelling compounds made of an acid and an alcohol – **Ans: Esters**
- Visual: **Marangoni effect**

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For feedback and suggestions

for 'Science', please write to
science@thehindu.co.in with the
subject 'Daily page'

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Public grievances received by Centre in last six months

15 lakh. Over 15 lakh public grievances have been received between January and July 15 this year, the Centre said. The government has undertaken initiatives to strengthen the Centralised Public Grievance Redress and Monitoring System to improve efficiency, quality and accountability. PTI

Occupancy rates across India's prison system in 2024

112.7 in per cent. India's prisons operated at 112.7% occupancy in 2024, with 609 jails housing more inmates than their sanctioned capacity and Delhi recording the highest occupancy rate of 194.6%, according to data tabled in the Rajya Sabha on Wednesday. PTI

Number of people executed in Iran since March 19, 2026

56 UN rights chief Volker Turk said on Wednesday he was "alarmed" by the surge in executions in Iran since March, with the death penalty being used by Tehran to "instil fear". "Since March 19, 2026, at least 56 people have been executed on national security-related charges," he said. AFP

Number of major online gambling sites banned by Sri Lanka

24 Sri Lanka has blocked access to some of the world's largest online betting sites as part of a crackdown on unauthorised gambling, the Digital Economy Ministry said. Online gambling is legal in Sri Lanka, but operators must register with the authorities and pay licence fees. AFP

Persons killed in monsoon floods, landslides in India

100 Floods and landslides triggered by monsoon rains have killed more than 100 people across India since July, official data showed on Wednesday, with thousands forced to flee their inundated homes. PTI
COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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The road ahead for the Asiatic lion

Six decades of conservation have increased the Asiatic lion population from about 100-150 to over 1,000, with nearly half now living outside the protected area; however, the species remains confined to single forested landscape, while habitat fragmentation, disease threats continue to pose major conservation challenges

FULL CONTEXT

Meena Venkataraman

The only free-ranging population of the Asiatic lion today survives in and around the Gir National Park and Sanctuary. The semi-arid landscape of Gir extends into expansive agricultural fields and traditional grasslands, forming a checkered landscape matrix. Dispersing lions use these habitats as passages, stepping stones, and refuges as they navigate riverbeds and mountainous terrain, eventually establishing territories far from their source population.

Lions today occupy habitats as ecologically distinct as the rugged hills of Girnar, the forests of Mitiyala, the landscapes around Savarkundla-Liliya, and the sandy coastal tracts stretching across Saurashtra to the Bhavnagar coast. What is perhaps most remarkable is that, at their destinations, these lions are accommodated by the local people.

As is evident, the challenge of lion conservation in Gujarat rests not only on protecting Gir, but also on safeguarding the network of habitats and corridors through which lions disperse and establish new territories. Around 50 lions inhabit the coastal habitats of Jafraabad Taluka, linked to the larger lion population through Babarkot. Significantly, the Gujarat Forest Department's 2025 lion population estimation identifies this coastal sector as Satellite IV, one of nine recognised satellite lion populations in the State, while the Gir Management Plan explicitly designates the Babarkot area as a lion movement corridor. Together, these official documents recognise the area as both an important satellite habitat and a crucial landscape linkage for dispersing lions.

A crucial corridor under pressure
It is against this backdrop that a recent proposal to divert approximately 75 hectares of reserved forest for limestone



An Asiatic Lioness with four cubs at Gir Sanctuary on May 12, 2025. VIJAY SONEJI

mining has generated concern. The apprehension is that such a move would run counter to the long-standing legal and management framework established to protect lion habitats and movement corridors. If mining were permitted, habitat disruption could functionally disconnect this coastal subpopulation from the larger forest-linked source population and displace lions from portions of their habitat.

The proposed project would reportedly require the felling of nearly 5,000 mature trees and affect a landscape that local communities themselves do not wish to see mined. Human-lion conflict could also intensify. The larger question is whether the prime habitat of a nationally treasured species, a landscape showcasing one of India's greatest conservation recoveries, should be sacrificed for private profit.

Over the six decades since the declaration of the Gir Sanctuary, the lion population has grown from about 100-150 individuals to a healthy population of over 1,000 today. More admirable, however, is the fact that nearly half of them now reside outside the designated protected area. Lions have, over the years, shown remarkable recovery, expansion and resilience, sustained by a resourceful habitat and a rich prey base.

The unfinished task

This success has been built through a transition from protected-area management to landscape-level conservation, supported by political will, capable administration, sustained funding and the goodwill of local communities. These have been the sturdy pillars of lion conservation.

However, the entire lion population remains confined to a single forested landscape. More puzzling has been the continued resistance to acknowledging the need for a second home for the lions. After years of downplaying the risk of disease in a geographically concentrated population, we received a jolt in 2018 when more than 20 lions succumbed to an outbreak of Canine Distemper Virus (CDV). The forest department responded with a series of immediate measures, but have we effectively applied the lessons learned from previous outbreaks?

Mortality is but a part of a natural demographic cycle. If we are to achieve long-term coexistence in shared spaces, we may even need to accommodate a degree of anthropogenic mortality. Yet the reports of lion deaths associated with babesiosis in May 2026, together with suggestions of possible CDV involvement, are worrying.

If disease exposes the vulnerability of

the population, land-use decisions expose the vulnerability of the landscape that sustains it. These controversies raise a broader question: have the once-strong pillars of the State's conservation legacy begun to weaken? Are cracks emerging in the framework that has sustained lion conservation for decades? Historically, there was little room for negotiation where lions and their habitat were concerned. Indeed, Gir remains an important case study of how protected areas were progressively expanded around the original sanctuary. Hopefully, there will be no shift in the vision underpinning the law, its application, or administrative decision-making.

Next chapter of recovery

Given the species' continuing conservation challenges, any ill-advised decision could yet turn the clock back to a far more precarious situation. The International Union for Conservation of Nature Red List tells an encouraging story: the Asiatic lion has moved from Critically Endangered to Endangered. Among the northern lion subpopulations, it is the only stable population exceeding 250 individuals and is therefore of immense global conservation significance. At the same time, the newer Green Status assessments remind us that recovery and restoration are not the same thing.

A species can recover substantially and still remain far from fully restored across its ecological and historical range. Under the Green Status framework, the lion remains largely depleted. While the lion has recovered from the brink, it remains far from fully restored across the landscape it once occupied.

The story of the Asiatic lion is one of sustained recovery achieved through six decades of unwavering conservation effort, and of the responsibility that comes with safeguarding those gains. Our goal is not merely to celebrate this legacy, but to sustain it.

(Meena Venkataraman, PhD, is a wildlife biologist with over two decades of experience in mammalian ecology, with a particular focus on the Asiatic lion)

THE GIST

▼ Landscape-level conservation, backed by political will, capable administration, sustained funding and local community support, has been the foundation of the Asiatic lion's recovery.

▼ Protecting habitats and movement corridors, addressing disease risks and securing a second home for the species are critical to sustaining India's lion conservation legacy.

Why is the Indian Statistical Institute Bill controversial?

What changes does the Bill propose to the governance of the ISI?

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan

The story so far:

The government has tabled a new Bill in Parliament, called the Indian Statistical Institute Bill, 2026, which will replace its approximately 67-year-old predecessor enacted in 1959. While seemingly innocuous, several provisions of the Bill have become contentious, with many faculty members of the Indian Statistical Institute (ISI) and MPs protesting against it.

What is the ISI?

In the 1920s, India's greatest statistician P.C. Mahalanobis set up the Statistical Laboratory in the Presidency College in Kolkata. On December 17, 1931, he founded the Indian Statistical Institute as a "learned society" housed in the Statistical Laboratory. The Institute was registered on April 28, 1932, as a non-profit distributing learned society

under the Societies Registration Act of 1860 and is now registered under the West Bengal Societies Registration Act of 1961, amended in 1964. The ISI quickly became India's premier statistical organisation. It was declared an Institution of National Importance through the Indian Statistical Institute Act, 1959.

What does the Bill seek to change?

At the most basic level, the new Bill seeks to bring ISI's governance structure on par with that of other Institutions of National Importance, such as the Indian Institutes of Management (IIMs) and the Indian Institutes of Technology (IITs).

According to the government, in the IITs and IIMs, compact empowered bodies such as the Board of Governors and executives such as Directors take decisions impacting both the day-to-day functioning and long-term policies of the organisations. However, ISI continues to follow the governance model of a society,

in which significant control is exercised by a large General Body of members of the society. A key outcome of this structure is that any amendment to the regulations can only be carried out with the approval of the General Body.

The government's contention is that since the regulations are prescriptive, even small reforms require the approval of the General Body.

Therefore, the new Bill is aimed at incorporating ISI into a statutory body corporate, strengthening its legal status and providing a "more robust and contemporary governance framework".

What will the governance model be?

The new Bill provides for the creation of a compact Board of Governors that will serve as the principal policy-making executive body of the ISI and will be accountable to the government. It also provides for the creation of an Academic Council as the principal academic body. The Board of Governors will consist of

11 members. The Board will be headed by a Chairperson, who is supposed to be an eminent person "in the field of academia, industry, education, public policy, Statistical Sciences and allied sciences, or other fields" and will be nominated by the Visitor (the President of India) on the recommendation of the Centre.

The government will also nominate a government official not below the level of Joint Secretary to the Government of India. The government's representation will further include another joint secretary or additional secretary.

The Board will include four eminent persons in the field of statistical sciences and allied fields, to be nominated by the Chairperson, and four representatives of the Institute who will include two members of the Academic Council to be nominated by the Board.

The Registrar of ISI will serve as the Secretary of the Board.

What is the controversy around the governance structure?

Ever since the draft Bill was made public last year, professors and officials of ISI have been protesting it. One main contention is that the new governance structure would wrest control of ISI from the people working there and place it in the hands of the Union government. The new structure does give the government direct or indirect control of eight out of the 11 members of the Board of Governors.

Were stakeholders consulted?

The critics say that the Bill has been prepared without consultations with the ISI Society, faculty members, students, or other stakeholders.

The government has argued that as per the review framework in the existing ISI Act, four Review Committees (RCs) have examined the functioning and progress of ISI. The second, third and fourth RCs suggested the reduction in size of the ISI Council, the government said. Despite this, the size of the Council of ISI increased over this period and currently numbers 33 members.

The fourth RC also pointed to certain structural and legacy issues.

Following this, the government said a brainstorming session had been organised by the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation on July 2, 2025, in collaboration with the ISI at the Jawaharlal Nehru Centre for Advanced Scientific Research in Bengaluru under the Chairpersonship of Dr. K. Radhakrishnan, the current Chairman of the ISI Governing Council. The aim was to "deliberate on pathways that can transform ISI into a world-class centre of learning and research, as it completes 100 years in 2031".

The government said, as per the pre-legislative consultation policy, comments and suggestions from the public on the draft Bill were invited and the timelines were extended in line with the requests of various stakeholders.

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